Nafs-Aql: A Verifier-Gated Dual-Process Architecture on Small Qwen Models for CPU-Only Deployment

Dirac R&D Team

***Abstract*—We present Nafs-Aql, a hybrid System 1 / System 2 language-model architecture built from small, openly licensed Qwen models and designed to run on a CPU-only machine. The design borrows its vocabulary, as an explicit analogy, from the classical Islamic account of the self: the impulsive *nafs*, the arbitrating *'aql*, the integrating *qalb*, and the practices of self-accounting (*muhasaba*) and purification (*tazkiya*). We turn this inspiration into a formal model with explicit state spaces, operators, costs and losses, and prove the properties that drive the engineering choices: the gate between the fast and slow paths is a threshold rule on a calibrated error estimate; precision on verifiable tasks is bounded by the verifier's false-accept rate and not by model strength; unverified self-refinement converges to a fixed point that can be worse than the first draft, while a verifier-gated loop has risk linear in the false-accept rate; plurality voting cannot repair confidently wrong tasks; and a Beta-prior optimal-stopping rule yields the retry cap. Each result is mapped to a parameter or an algorithm of the specification. We verify the stack against current documentation: Qwen3 and Qwen3.5 are the only Qwen generations with open weights at or below 9B parameters; vLLM's CPU backend requires Linux and prefers AVX-512; Unsloth requires a GPU for training, so fine-tuning is scheduled on rented GPUs with GGUF export for CPU inference; and a Rust gateway (axum, tokio) fronts both vLLM and llama-server through the OpenAI-compatible API. On the reference machine (Intel i3-8100, AVX2, 32 GB) we measured 15.5 decoded tokens/s for Qwen3-1.7B in 4-bit, consistent with a memory-bandwidth roofline. We give the architecture, the implementation stack, the evaluation plan with statistically sized gates, and a summary of the companion specification and roadmap. Version 2.0 adds the implemented system and its measurements on a shared four-core CPU. With an exact verifier visible, the gate matched deliberate-only accuracy at about a third of its cost. Stage-level latency attribution shows that System 1 decode speed dominates the fast path, and an early-escalation rule removes the remainder of drafts the gate will reject anyway. A Qwen3.5-2B System 1 was 17 points more accurate but 3.7 times slower, so it was not adopted. These quality results are indicative: sample sizes are far below the release gates.**

***Index Terms*—dual-process reasoning, test-time compute, routing, verification, small language models, Qwen, CPU inference, Islamic philosophy of mind, Rust.**

I. Introduction

Reasoning-tuned language models answer hard questions by spending more computation at inference time: they sample long chains of thought, draw several candidates, and verify or vote among them [1]–[4]. The gain is real but expensive, and it is wasted on the many requests that a direct answer would have handled [5], [6]. This is the engineering form of a very old observation: cognition has a fast, automatic mode and a slow, effortful one, and competence lies in knowing when to switch [7]–[9].

The Islamic intellectual tradition developed a rich vocabulary for the same observation long before dual-process psychology. The Qur'an speaks of the *nafs* that "commands to evil" (Q 12:53), the *nafs* that reproaches itself (Q 75:2) and the *nafs* "at rest" (Q 89:27) [10]; al-Ghazali describes the heart (*qalb*) as a king whose vizier is the intellect (*'aql*) and whose unruly soldiers are appetite and anger [11]; and the Sufi disciplines of *muraqaba* (vigilance) and *muhasaba* (self-accounting) institutionalise the daily audit of one's own conduct [12], [13]. We use this vocabulary as a design metaphor. We make no claim about the metaphysics of the soul, and we say so once here and again in Section II-A: every mapping in this paper is an analogy between a classical *description of a faculty* and an *engineering component*.

A. Problem

The project that this report serves has a concrete constraint set: build a dual-process assistant from pretrained Qwen models, serve it on a CPU-only machine, fine-tune it with Unsloth, and expose it through a Rust web application with a chat room, a performance-test console and an evaluation dashboard. An existing draft design [14] targeted 27B–35B models on 80 GB GPUs and reviewed twelve formal results; it did not address CPU feasibility, the model roster, the serving stack, or a buildable specification. This report assesses that draft, keeps what is sound, corrects what is not, and extends it into a mathematically principled and feasible design.

B. Contributions

1) A faithful, sourced account of the classical concepts we borrow, with the disagreements among scholars noted and the analogy kept separate from theology (Section II-A).
2) A formal model of a verifier-gated dual-process system with seventeen stated results, each with explicit assumptions and an engineering consequence (Section III). The results correct two defects of the draft: its router rule was hand-tuned rather than derived, and its self-refinement loop was not shown to be stable.
3) A verified feasibility study of the stack as of October 2026: which Qwen variants exist below 9B parameters, which run

Manuscript prepared 18 October 2026 (version 2.0: design and implementation). Contact: Dirac R&D Team. Section IX reports measured results of the implemented system; elsewhere, performance figures are targets or estimates unless marked as measured.

in vLLM-CPU and llama.cpp, what Unsloth can and cannot do without a GPU, which Rust crates to use, and what a four-core AVX2 machine actually delivers (Sections V and V-D).
4) A component architecture with a termination guarantee, an assurance-level model for answers, and a self-model that is unbiased under routing (Section IV).
5) An evaluation plan whose gates are statistically sized, and a summary of the companion specification and roadmap (Sections VII and VIII).

C. What this report does not claim

No accuracy, calibration or cost result for Nafs-Aql has been measured. Where a number appears it is (a) a measurement of an existing model on the reference machine, clearly marked, (b) a value quoted from a cited paper, or (c) a target or estimate. The roadmap (Section VII) schedules every hypothesis for validation.

II. Background

A. The Islamic Account of the Self

1) Scope and disclaimer: We summarise the classical vocabulary we borrow, from primary texts in verified translations and from standard scholarship. The summary is descriptive. We attribute each concept to a specific author and text, note where scholars disagree, and do not present "the Islamic view of the soul" as one fixed scheme. The engineering mapping of Section IV is an analogy between faculty descriptions and software components; it is not a claim that the software has a soul, a heart or an intellect in the sense of the sources. We do not model the *ruh* (spirit), which the Qur'an places beyond human analysis (Q 17:85), and we do not map divine inspiration (*ilham*), unveiling (*mukashafa*) or the Active Intellect of the philosophers onto any component.

2) The nafs and its Qur'anic stages: Nafs most often means simply "self" or "person". Three verses attach a qualifying adjective and these became the seeds of the later Sufi "stations" of the soul [10], [15]: *al-nafs al-ammarah bi-l-su'*, the self that commands to evil (Q 12:53); *al-nafs al-lawwamah*, the self-reproaching self (Q 75:2); and *al-nafs al-mutma'innah*, the self at rest (Q 89:27), addressed in the next verse as "well pleased and well pleasing" (*radiyah*, *mardiyyah*, Q 89:28). Q 91:7–10 says the soul was "inspired" with its wickedness and its God-consciousness and that whoever purifies it (*zakkaha*) succeeds. Only the first three are fixed noun–adjective pairs in the text. The "inspired self" (*al-nafs al-mulhamah*) is a Sufi coinage from the verb in Q 91:8, and the "perfect" or "pure" self (*kamilah*, *safiyyah*, *zakiyyah*) is a later elaboration. Later manuals arrange seven stages, commonly *ammarah*, *lawwamah*, *mulhamah*, *mutma'innah*, *radiyah*, *mardiyyah*, *kamilah*, but the order and the name of the highest rung vary by order and author [16]. A recent grounded-theory model of the soul for Islamic psychotherapy deliberately keeps only the three Qur'anic stages [17]. We follow the same restraint: our trace-state automaton (Fig. 3) uses the three Qur'anic stages as mnemonics and names its other states in plain engineering terms.

3) Al-Ghazali: heart, intellect, soul, spirit: In Book 21 of the *Ihya'*, "The Marvels of the Heart", al-Ghazali (d. 1111) distinguishes two senses of each of four words [11]. *Qalb* is the organ of flesh and also a spiritual subtlety that is the knowing, perceiving human being; *ruh* is the physicians' subtle vapour and also that same subtlety; *nafs* is the aggregate of appetite and anger, the blameworthy lower self of Q 12:53, and also the same subtlety named *mutma'innah*, *lawwamah* or *ammarah* according to its state; and *'aql* is knowledge of the real natures of things and also the perceiving subtlety itself. In their second sense the four words name one entity under different aspects. Al-Ghazali's political image is the one we borrow: the heart is a king, the intellect is its vizier and counsellor, appetite is its provisioner and anger its police; the kingdom is well ordered when the king consults the vizier and uses the other two without letting them rule. He also describes the heart as a mirror in which the forms of things are reflected, tarnished by vice and polished by remembrance and discipline; incoming thoughts (*khawatir*) that call to good are *ilham* and those that call to evil are *waswasa*. Books 22–23 give the practical programme of disciplining the soul [18]. Al-Ghazali adopts Avicennan faculty psychology in all of this [19]–[21], and treats error as a structural failure of the soul's faculties [22].

4) Muraqaba and muhasaba: Book 38 of the *Ihya'* is devoted to vigilance and self-accounting: the servant sets conditions on the self in the morning, watches it through the day (*muraqaba*), and audits it at night (*muhasaba*), then corrects and strives. The vocabulary goes back to al-Harith al-Muhasibi (d. 857), whose name derives from the practice [12]; al-Qushayri's *Risala* has chapters on both and a lexicon that distinguishes *nafs*, *qalb*, *ruh* and *sirr* as successively subtler faculties [13]. The engineering reading is direct: muhasaba is self-correction *under a standard*, which is what an evaluation and monitoring loop does, and *tazkiyat al-nafs* (purification) is the long-run change of disposition that such a loop is meant to produce.

5) Ibn Sina: internal senses and intellect: Avicenna (d. 1037) defines the soul as the first perfection of a natural body with organs and distinguishes the vegetative, animal and rational souls [23]–[26]. He systematises five internal senses located in the brain's ventricles [27]: the common sense and the retentive imagination in the front ventricle, the estimative faculty (*wahm*) and the compositive imagination in the middle, and memory (*dhakira*) in the rear. *Wahm* grasps non-sensible "intentions" such as the hostility of a wolf; it is the quick, particular judgement that animals and humans share and a frequent source of error [28]. The theoretical intellect passes from potentiality through habit and act to the "acquired" intellect, receiving intelligibles from a separate Active Intellect, a doctrine al-Ghazali criticised and later philosophers replaced [29], [30]. The "flying man" thought experiment argues that self-awareness is primitive and does not depend on the body; whether it is a demonstration or a pointer is disputed [31], [32].

6) Ibn Arabi, Suhrawardi, Mulla Sadra: Ibn Arabi (d. 1240) names the heart from *taqallub*, fluctuation: it follows what reason, from *'iqal* (the fetter), cannot encompass, and sound

knowledge needs both of the heart's "two eyes", reason and imagination [33], [34]. Suhrawardi (d. 1191) holds that the soul knows itself and its states by presence, without an intervening form [35], [36]. Mulla Sadra (d. 1636) teaches substantial motion: the soul is "bodily in its origination, spiritual in its subsistence", intensifying through sensory, imaginal and intellectual stages, and in the act of knowing the knower and the known are one [37]–[39]. The draft design mapped substantial motion to distillation (slow reasoning becoming fast); we keep the mapping as an illustration of *gradual change of disposition* and nothing more.

7) Where scholars disagree: Whether *nafs* and *ruh* are one entity; whether *'aql* is a faculty, a body of knowledge or a substance; whether the soul is immaterial from the start (Avicenna), a subtle body (much of early kalam), or material in origin and immaterial in subsistence (Sadra); whether the Active Intellect is needed; how many stages the *nafs* has; and even what al-Ghazali himself believed [19], [40], [41]: all of these are open in the literature. Our analogy does not depend on any of them being settled.

8) Rules we follow: (1) Every borrowing is presented as an analogy and the components keep plain engineering names in code. (2) We use the faculty-psychology vocabulary (*nafs*, *'aql*, *qalb*, *wahm*, *dhakira*, *muhasaba*, *tazkiya*) and nothing from the vocabulary of revelation. (3) The stage ladder is not a maturity model or a benchmark scale. (4) Scripture is cited by chapter and verse in a named translation and hadith by collection and number; we quote no unsourced sayings. (5) The analogy section should be reviewed by a scholar of the tradition before publication.

B. Dual-Process Theory and Metareasoning

Dual-process accounts distinguish a fast, automatic, associative mode from a slow, effortful, rule-based one [7], [9], [42]. The contemporary formulation of Evans and Stanovich defines Type 1 processing by autonomy and Type 2 by its demand on working memory and its capacity for hypothetical thought, and treats the question of *when* Type 2 intervenes as central [8]. Two further lines matter for us. The *expected value of control* theory of Shenhav, Botvinick and Cohen models the allocation of cognitive control as a cost–benefit decision [43]; resource-rational analysis makes the same move for cognition in general [44]; and the metareasoning literature in artificial intelligence, from Russell and Wefald onward, asks how an agent should decide which computations to run [45]. Theorem 2 is the one-step instance of these ideas: deliberate when its expected value exceeds its cost.

C. Fast and Slow Language Models

1) Test-time compute: Chain-of-thought prompting elicits multi-step reasoning [1]; sampling several chains and voting improves accuracy, by $+17.9$ points on GSM8K in the original study [2]. Coverage, the chance that at least one of N samples is correct, grows roughly log-linearly in N across orders of magnitude, but without an automatic verifier the gain from voting or reward models plateaus after a few hundred samples [46]; trained verifiers and process-supervised reward models recover much of it [47], [48]. Allocating test-time compute per prompt according to difficulty is more than four times as efficient as uniform best-of-N and, in a FLOPs-matched comparison, can beat a model fourteen times larger on problems the small model can sometimes solve [3]. Reinforcement learning induces long reasoning traces with self-verification [4], [49], [50]; a thousand curated examples plus "budget forcing" already yields a strong reasoner [51]. Qwen3 ships both modes in one model with a thinking budget [52].

2) Self-correction: Prompting a model to critique and revise its own answer helps on some tasks [53], [54] but, without external feedback, intrinsic self-correction does not improve reasoning and can degrade it [55]; a survey concludes that self-correction works with reliable external feedback or large-scale fine-tuning [56]. Theorem 4 gives the simplest model in which this happens. Reasoning models also *over*think simple questions [5].

3) Deciding when to think: A rapidly growing literature trains or prompts models to choose between a direct answer and a reasoning trace per query [6], [57]–[61], with typical reports of 40–90% fewer reasoning tokens at equal or better accuracy on mathematics benchmarks. Recent work allocates budgets across sub-questions or across a batch of questions [62]–[67]. Earlier, planning-oriented work combined fast and slow modes in a single transformer [68], [69], and the AI community has framed the agenda explicitly in dual-process terms [70], [71].

4) Routing and cascades: Routing between a cheap and an expensive model on predicted difficulty [72], [73] or cascading on the weak model's answer consistency [74], [75] reduces cost by 40–98% at matched quality in the cited studies. The classical foundations are Chow's reject option [76], selective classification with risk guarantees [77] and learning to defer [78], [79]. Calibration of the routing signal is the crux [80]–[82]; conformal methods give distribution-free coverage when a held-out set is available [83].

5) Speculative and parallel decoding: Speculative decoding drafts with a cheap model and verifies in parallel with the target, preserving the target distribution [84], [85]; Medusa and EAGLE replace the draft model with extra heads [86], [87], and multi-token prediction heads serve the same purpose [88]. Learned per-token compute allocation [89], [90] is the architectural cousin of our per-request gate. In Nafs-Aql, speculative decoding is an *inside-the-model* accelerator, orthogonal to the System 1/System 2 split; llama.cpp's n-gram speculation needs no draft model and is the only variant we plan on the CPU baseline (Section V).

6) Autoregressive and non-autoregressive Qwen: Non-autoregressive generation began in translation [91], [92] and is now pursued as discrete diffusion [93]–[95]. LLaDA trains an 8B masked-diffusion model from scratch [96]; Dream 7B and Dream-Coder are initialised from Qwen2.5 weights [97]; DiffuCoder adapts Qwen2.5-Coder [98]; block diffusion interpolates between the two paradigms [99], and SDAR and TraDo convert Qwen3 base models (1.7B–30B-A3B) into block-diffusion reasoners [100], [101]; Fast-dLLM v2 converts Qwen2.5 with about a billion tokens [102]; training-free caching and parallel decoding give large throughput gains

TABLE I
QWEN GENERATIONS AND OPEN TEXT MODELS $\leq$9B (VERIFIED ON HUGGING FACE, 2026-10-18)

Generation	Released	Open $\leq$9B	Architecture, notes
Qwen3	Apr 2025; 2507 refresh	0.6B, 1.7B, 4B, 8B; 4B-Instruct-2507, 4B-Thinking-2507	Dense GQA (`Qwen3ForCausalLM`); thinking switch; official GGUF; Apache-2.0
Qwen3.5	Feb–Mar 2026	0.8B, 2B, 4B, 9B	Hybrid 3:1 Gated DeltaNet : gated attention; vision encoder built in; 262K context; no official GGUF; Apache-2.0
Qwen3.6	Apr 2026	none (27B, 35B-A3B)	Same hybrid family
Qwen3.7	May 2026	none (API only)	Closed
Qwen3.8	Aug 2026	none (27B, 2.4T-A95B, Flash-Next)	Hybrid; new `qwen4_exp` for Flash-Next

[103]; commercial diffusion models report thousands of tokens per second on GPUs [104]; see the survey [105]. Jacobi-style parallel decoding of ordinary autoregressive models is a third route [106], [107]. **Verification result:** as of October 2026 there is no official non-autoregressive Qwen model from the Qwen team; every Qwen-based diffusion model is a third-party adaptation, and only the Dream family runs in llama.cpp's diffusion example on CPU. Diffusion decoding is therefore *not* on the critical path of Nafs-Aql; it is an optional System 1 accelerator evaluated in Phase 5, and only if a CPU-capable runtime exists for a Qwen3-derived checkpoint by then.

7) Qwen generations: Table I summarises the Qwen generations available in October 2026. Only Qwen3 [52] and Qwen3.5 [108] have open weights at or below 9B parameters; Qwen3.6 and Qwen3.8 start at 27B dense or 35B-A3B [109]–[111], and Qwen3.7 has no open weights. The draft design's roster (Qwen3.6-27B and Qwen3.6-35B-A3B) is therefore real but outside any CPU budget considered here (about 16–22 GB at 4 bits).

III. MATHEMATICAL FORMULATION

This section turns the inspiration of Section II into a formal model. Nothing here depends on the metaphysical reading: the objects are policies, verifiers, costs and losses. Each result ends with its *engineering consequence*, which the specification (Section VII) turns into a parameter or an algorithm. Results are labelled by the strength of their assumptions: **[exact]** holds under the stated model without further hypotheses; **[strong]** needs an assumption that must be checked empirically; **[conjecture]** is a design hypothesis scheduled for validation in the roadmap.

A. Objects

Definition 1 (Task, answer, correctness)**.** A *task* is $x \in \mathcal{X}$ (a query together with its conversational context). An *answer* is $y \in \mathcal{Y}$. Correctness is an unobserved indicator $\kappa(x, y) \in \{0, 1\}$. A task is *verifiable* if a deterministic procedure can evaluate κ (unit tests, numeric or symbolic equality, schema validity); otherwise it is *non-verifiable*.

Definition 2 (Fast and slow paths)**.** The *fast path* (System 1, the analogue of the impulsive *nafs*) is a stochastic policy $\pi_1(y \mid x)$ with expected cost $c_1(x)$ and correctness probability $p_1(x) = \mathbb{P}_{y\sim\pi_1}[\kappa(x, y) = 1]$. The *slow path* (System 2, deliberation) is a policy $\pi_2(y \mid x, b)$ parametrised by a *thinking budget* $b \in \mathbb{N}$ (maximum reasoning tokens), with cost $c_2(x, b)$ and correctness $p_2(x, b)$. Costs are measured in a common unit (seconds of CPU time or tokens weighted by a tariff).

Definition 3 (Verifier)**.** A *verifier* is a map $V : \mathcal{X}\times\mathcal{Y} \to \{0, 1\}$ with true-accept rate $r = \mathbb{P}[V = 1 \mid \kappa = 1]$ and false-accept rate $\varphi = \mathbb{P}[V = 1 \mid \kappa = 0]$. A verifier is *exact* if $\varphi = 0$ and $r = 1$ on its domain. Soft verifiers (rubric judges, consensus) have $\varphi > 0$ and must publish measured (r, φ).

Definition 4 (Gate and trace state)**.** After the fast path has run, the *controller* (the *'aql* analogue) observes a feature vector $s = \sigma(x, \text{trace}_1) \in \mathcal{S}$ (token log-probabilities, agreement among cheap samples, verifier outcome, domain class) and chooses, with probability $\gamma(s) \in [0, 1]$, to *escalate* to the slow path. The lifecycle of one request is a finite automaton over the *trace states* $\mathcal{Z} = \{\mathsf{A}, \mathsf{L}, \mathsf{M}, \mathsf{T}, \mathsf{X}\}$ of Fig. 3: A (an unverified draft), L (the draft has been flagged by the gate or a verifier), M (a deliberate retry conditioned on evidence), T (an accepted answer) and X (abstention with an explicit uncertainty notice). The labels are mnemonic for the four classical stages of the *nafs* (Section II-A); the automaton itself is an ordinary bounded retry loop.

Definition 5 (Losses and objective)**.** A wrong answer costs $L > 0$, an abstention costs $L_a \in (0, L)$, and compute is priced by $\lambda > 0$ per cost unit. For a controller $\theta = (\gamma, b, N, R)$ (gate, thinking budget, samples per round, retry rounds) the design objective is

$$\mathcal{J}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_x\big[L\,\mathbb{P}[\text{wrong} \mid x, \theta] + L_a\,\mathbb{P}[\text{abstain} \mid x, \theta] + \lambda\,\mathbb{E}[\text{cost} \mid x, \theta]\big]. \tag{1}$$

Lemma 1 (Termination)**.** [exact] *With at most N slow-path samples per round and at most R retry rounds, every request makes at most $1 + N(R{+}1)$ model calls and at most $1 + N(R{+}1)$ verifier calls before reaching T or X.*

Proof. Each transition of the automaton either consumes one of the $N(R{+}1)$ slow samples or terminates; the fast path is called once. □ □

Consequence. Every request has a hard upper bound on latency (NFR-001 in the specification); the gateway MUST enforce N and R as configuration limits rather than letting the model decide when to stop.

B. Precision of a verified answer

Theorem 1 (Verified-return precision)**.** [exact] *Let a candidate be correct with prior probability p and let it be accepted by a verifier with rates (r, φ). Then*

$$\rho(p) \;=\; \mathbb{P}[\textit{wrong} \mid \textit{accepted}] = \frac{\varphi(1-p)}{\varphi(1-p) + r\,p}, \tag{2}$$

and $\rho(p) \leq \varepsilon$ if and only if $\varphi \leq \dfrac{\varepsilon\, r\, p}{(1-\varepsilon)(1-p)}$. If k verifiers are applied and their acceptances are conditionally

independent given κ, the same holds with $\varphi \leftarrow \prod_i \varphi_i$ and $r \leftarrow \prod_i r_i$.

Proof. Bayes' rule with $\mathbb{P}[\text{accepted}] = \varphi(1-p) + rp$. Solving $\rho \le \varepsilon$ for φ gives the bound. Conditional independence factorises the joint acceptance probabilities. □ □

Consequence. The precision of the system on verifiable tasks is bounded by the verifier's false-accept rate, not by the strength of either model. Every verifier in the hub MUST publish (r, φ) measured by mutation testing on a held-out set (FR-030), and the per-verifier acceptance threshold is 1.0 for exact verifiers. For hard tasks ($p = 0.1$) a 1% precision target requires $\varphi \le 1.1 \times 10^{-3}$: only exact verifiers qualify, which is why consensus (Theorem 6) is a flag and not a verifier.

C. The gate is a threshold rule

Let $e_1(s) = \mathbb{P}[\text{fast answer wrong} \mid s]$, $e_2(s) = \mathbb{P}[\text{final answer wrong after escalation} \mid s]$ and $\Delta c(s) = \mathbb{E}[\text{extra cost of escalation} \mid s]$.

Theorem 2 (Optimal gate)**.** [exact]

(i) The gate minimising (1) *escalates if and only if*

$$L\,\big(e_1(s) - e_2(s)\big) \;>\; \lambda\,\Delta c(s), \tag{3}$$

with ties broken arbitrarily.

(ii) Under a budget constraint $\mathbb{E}[\gamma(s)\Delta c(s)] \le B$ instead of the price λ, the optimal gate escalates if and only if $\big(e_1(s) - e_2(s)\big)/\Delta c(s) > \lambda^\star$, where $\lambda^\star$ is the smallest multiplier that meets the budget; randomisation is needed only on the level set $\{s : (e_1 - e_2)/\Delta c = \lambda^\star\}$.

(iii) If $e_1 - e_2$ is non-decreasing in a scalar score s and Δc is constant, the rule is a single threshold $s > \tau$.

Proof. (i) Conditional on s, keeping costs $Le_1(s)$ and escalating costs $\lambda\Delta c(s) + Le_2(s)$; the objective is an expectation over s of a pointwise choice, so pointwise minimisation is optimal. (ii) The Lagrangian $\mathbb{E}[\gamma(s)(Le_2 + \lambda\Delta c - Le_1)]$ is linear in γ; by the Neyman–Pearson lemma the optimal γ is an indicator of a likelihood-ratio set with randomisation on the boundary. (iii) Immediate from (i). □ □

Consequence. The controller is implemented as a calibrated estimator $\hat{e}_1(s)$ (logistic or isotonic regression on the fast-path features), a per-domain estimate $\hat{e}_2$, and the comparison (3). The only tunable is the cost ratio $\lambda\Delta c/L$ (or equivalently the budget B), which the operator sets; the threshold is *derived*, not hand-tuned (FR-010–FR-013). The rule coincides with Chow's optimal reject rule [76] and with the expected-value-of-control account of cognitive control [43], with "reject" read as "deliberate".

Proposition 1 (Price of miscalibration)**.** [exact] *If the plug-in gate uses estimates with $\sup_s |\hat{e}_1(s) - e_1(s)| \le \epsilon_1$ and $\sup_s |\hat{e}_2(s) - e_2(s)| \le \epsilon_2$, its objective exceeds that of the optimal gate by at most $L(\epsilon_1 + \epsilon_2)$.*

Proof. At any s the two gates disagree only if $|L(e_1 - e_2) - \lambda\Delta c| \le L(\epsilon_1 + \epsilon_2)$, and the loss from a wrong decision equals that absolute difference. Taking expectations over s gives the bound. □ □

Consequence. The calibration target of the gate (NFR-020) is set from the regret the operator tolerates: a maximum calibration error of 0.05 on $\hat{e}_1$ bounds the excess loss by $0.05L$ per request.

Proposition 2 (Cost–quality frontier)**.** [exact] *The set of achievable pairs (expected cost, expected error) over all gates γ is convex, and its lower-left boundary is traced by the family of threshold gates of Theorem 2 as λ varies.*

Proof. Both coordinates are linear in γ, so mixtures of gates achieve mixtures of pairs; the boundary of a convex set is supported by linear functionals, each of which is minimised by a threshold gate by Theorem 2. □ □

Consequence. The user-facing "speed–care" control in the chat UI is a single scalar λ (FR-014); no other knob can reach a better point.

D. Deliberation: sampling, stopping and retries

Let a slow-path round draw one candidate and verify it; let $a = q\,r + (1-q)\varphi$ be the probability that a draw is accepted, where q is the probability that a draw is correct.

Theorem 3 (Coverage and cost of sequential verified sampling)**.** [exact] *With at most M draws and stopping at the first acceptance, (i) the probability that some candidate is accepted is $1 - (1-a)^M$; (ii) the expected number of draws is $E(M) = \big(1 - (1-a)^M\big)/a$; (iii) the conditional error of the accepted candidate is $\rho(q)$ of Theorem 1, independent of M; (iv) if a varies across tasks with mean $\bar{a}$, the coverage is at most $1 - (1-\bar{a})^M$.*

Proof. (i)–(ii) are the truncated geometric distribution. (iii) Each accepted candidate, whichever draw produced it, is wrong with probability $\rho(q)$ by Bayes' rule. (iv) $u \mapsto (1-u)^M$ is convex, so Jensen's inequality gives $\mathbb{E}[(1-a)^M] \ge (1-\bar{a})^M$. □ □

Consequence. More samples buy *coverage*, never *precision*: the number of draws is chosen from a coverage target and the per-task heterogeneity of a must be measured, not averaged (Phase 0 of the roadmap).

Proposition 3 (Optimal number of draws under uncertainty about a)**.** [strong: Beta prior, monotone stopping] *Suppose the acceptance probability of a task is unknown with prior $a \sim \mathrm{Beta}(\alpha, \beta)$, each draw costs c_p, and failing to produce an accepted candidate costs L_a. After m consecutive rejections the posterior mean is $a_m = \alpha/(\alpha + \beta + m)$. The policy that draws again if and only if $a_m L_a > c_p$ is optimal, so the optimal cap is*

$$M^\star = \left\lceil \frac{\alpha L_a}{c_p} - \alpha - \beta \right\rceil \tag{4}$$

(the number of $m \ge 0$ with $\alpha/(\alpha+\beta+m) > c_p/L_a$), when the right-hand side is positive, and $M^\star = 0$ otherwise.

Proof. A further draw costs c_p and, with posterior-predictive probability a_m, saves L_a; so the one-step look-ahead rule continues iff $a_m L_a > c_p$. Because every continuation happens

only after a rejection and a_m is decreasing in m, once the rule says "stop" it says "stop" in all subsequent states: the problem is monotone, and in the monotone case the one-step look-ahead rule is optimal [112]. The draws made are exactly those indexed by the $m \geq 0$ with $m < \alpha L_a/c_p - \alpha - \beta$, whose count is the ceiling. □ □

Consequence. The retry limit R and the samples per round N (with $M = N(R+1)$) are derived per domain from the Phase-0 fit of (α, β) and the operator's cost ratio c_p/L_a (FR-021). The Beta model is a modelling choice; the roadmap validates it against the empirical distribution of acceptance rates (hypothesis H3).

E. Self-monitoring: why the loop must be verifier-gated

The classical *muhasaba* (self-accounting) is a loop in which a draft is re-examined and amended. Let u be the probability that one unverified refinement turns a wrong answer into a right one and d the probability that it turns a right answer into a wrong one.

Theorem 4 (Unverified refinement converges to a fixed point)**.** [strong: homogeneous Markov refinement] *If q_t is the probability that the t-th draft is correct and $q_{t+1} = q_t(1-d)+(1-q_t)u$, then $q_t = q^\star + (q_0 - q^\star)(1-u-d)^t$ with $q^\star = u/(u+d)$. In particular q_t decreases monotonically in t whenever $q_0 > q^\star$.*

Proof. The recursion is affine with fixed point $q^\star$ and contraction factor $1-u-d \in (-1,1)$ for $u+d \in (0,2)$. □ □

Consequence. Iterating self-critique without external evidence can only help tasks whose first draft is worse than the fixed point; for a strong first draft it *harms*. This is consistent with the empirical finding that language models do not reliably self-correct without external feedback [55], [56]. Nafs-Aql therefore never accepts an unverified refinement: on non-verifiable tasks the loop is capped at $R = 1$ (FR-022).

Theorem 5 (Verifier-gated loop is stable)**.** [exact] *In a loop that accepts a candidate only when a verifier with rates (r, φ) passes it, and whose t-th candidate is correct with probability q_t, the probability of terminating with an accepted wrong answer is at most $\varphi\,\mathbb{E}[T]$, where T is the number of candidates examined, and the error conditional on acceptance lies in $[\min_t \rho(q_t), \max_t \rho(q_t)]$. Neither bound depends on the refinement dynamics (u, d).*

Proof. A wrong candidate at round t is accepted with probability φ; summing $\mathbb{P}[\text{reach } t]\,(1-q_t)\varphi \leq \varphi\mathbb{P}[\text{reach } t]$ over t gives $\varphi\,\mathbb{E}[T]$. Conditional on acceptance at round t the error is $\rho(q_t)$ by Theorem 1; the overall conditional error is a mixture of these values. □ □

Consequence. With a verifier in the loop the risk is linear in φ and in the expected number of rounds, both of which the controller bounds (Lemma 1); the refinement prompt can be changed freely without re-deriving the safety case.

F. Consensus has a floor

Theorem 6 (Plurality voting converges to the modal answer)**.** [exact] *Let N answers be drawn i.i.d. from $\pi(\cdot \mid x)$ over a finite answer set with a unique mode $y^\circ(x)$. Then the plurality vote converges almost surely to $y^\circ(x)$ as $N \to \infty$, so the limiting accuracy of self-consistency is $\mathbb{P}_x[\,y^\circ(x) \text{ is correct}\,]$. For finite N, if the correct answer has mass q and the strongest wrong answer has mass $\bar{q} < q$, the probability that the wrong answer ties or beats the correct one is at most $\exp\big(-N(q-\bar{q})^2/2\big)$.*

Proof. The empirical frequencies converge almost surely to $\pi(\cdot \mid x)$ (strong law), so the arg-max converges to the unique mode. For the finite bound let $D_i = \mathbb{1}[y_i = y^\star] - \mathbb{1}[y_i = \bar{y}] \in [-1, 1]$ with mean $q - \bar{q}$; Hoeffding's inequality [113] gives $\mathbb{P}[\sum_i D_i \leq 0] \leq \exp(-2N(q-\bar{q})^2/4)$. □ □

Consequence. Agreement among samples cannot repair tasks on which the model is confidently wrong; the mass of such tasks is a floor that no N removes. Consensus is therefore recorded as an *assurance level* (`consensus`) distinct from `verified` (FR-031), is never used to write training data without a human check, and the number of samples for a consensus flag is set from the margin $q - \bar{q}$ measured in Phase 0.

G. Independence of the two paths

Proposition 4 (Anchoring and collision)**.** [exact] *If the slow path does not see the fast draft, the probability that both produce the same wrong answer is the collision probability $\sum_{y:\kappa(x,y)=0} \pi_1(y \mid x)\pi_2(y \mid x)$. Passing the draft to the slow path can only add anchoring on top of this value. Certifying an adoption rate below 5% at confidence 95% with zero observed adoptions needs at least $\lceil \ln 0.05 / \ln 0.95 \rceil = 59$ trials; with observed adoptions the Clopper–Pearson interval [114] applies.*

Consequence. The slow path is *draft-blind* by default (FR-023); draft-conditioned deliberation is an ablation, and the coupling test (hypothesis H5) is a release gate. Because both paths may share weights (the single-model profile of Section IV-E), the collision term is not small a priori and is measured.

H. Honest self-knowledge under routing

Proposition 5 (Unbiased capability estimates need audits)**.** [exact] *Slow-path correctness is observed only on escalated tasks, so the naive estimate is $\mathbb{P}[\text{slow correct} \mid \text{escalated}]$, a biased estimate of p_2. If a random fraction $\epsilon > 0$ of the kept tasks is also run through the slow path, then with escalation rate g, $\hat{p}_2 = g\,\hat{p}_{2|\text{esc}} + (1-g)\,\hat{p}_{2|\text{audit}}$ is unbiased, with standard error at most $\frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\big(g + (1-g)/\epsilon\big)/n}$ over n requests.*

Proof. Inverse-probability weighting with known strata weights g and $1-g$ and sampling probabilities 1 and ϵ; the variance of each stratum mean is at most $1/(4\,n_{\text{stratum}})$ with $n_{\text{esc}} = ng$ and $n_{\text{audit}} = n(1-g)\epsilon$. □ □

Consequence. The self-model (the *muhasaba* ledger) is built only from traces plus a 5% audit stream (FR-040); capabilities with no audited data are reported as *unmeasured*, never as zero. With $n = 10^4$, $g = 0.3$ and $\epsilon = 0.05$ the standard error is at most 0.019.

I. Estimation and gate sample sizes

Proposition 6 (Sample sizes)**.** [exact]

(i) (Threshold from a quantile.) If τ is set as the empirical $(1-g^\star)$-quantile of n i.i.d. scores, the realised escalation rate is within ε of $g^\star$ with probability at least $1-\delta$ whenever $n \geq \ln(2/\delta)/(2\varepsilon^2)$ [115].

(ii) (Non-inferiority.) To show that the cascade loses at most m points of accuracy against the slow-only baseline with power $1-\beta$ at level α, a paired design with discordance rate δ needs $n \geq (z_\alpha + z_\beta)^2\,\delta/m^2$ pairs.

(iii) (Binomial gates.) Certifying a rate below ε with zero failures at confidence $1-\delta$ needs $n \geq \ln\delta/\ln(1-\varepsilon)$ trials.

Consequence. The Phase-0 baseline is at least $4\,600$ tasks ($\varepsilon = 0.02$, $\delta = 0.05$), the one-point non-inferiority gate needs about $6\,200$ pairs at $\delta = 0.1$ (or 700 for a three-point margin), and every release gate in the roadmap states its sample size. With $n = 500$ the escalation rate is known only to ± 6 points.

J. Distillation (tazkiya) without self-deception

Proposition 7 (Label noise and verifier-inflated gains)**.** [exact]

(i) If a fraction η of training labels is wrong, then for every hypothesis h, $|\mathrm{err}_{noisy}(h) - \mathrm{err}_{clean}(h)| \leq \eta$; with verifier-filtered traces $\eta = \rho$ of Theorem 1.

(ii) If accuracy is measured with a verifier of rates (r, φ), the measured rate is $\varphi + (r-\varphi)\,t$ where t is the true rate; a measured gain Δ corresponds to a true gain $\Delta/(r-\varphi)$, and training on verifier-accepted outputs can raise φ and inflate the measurement.

(iii) A paired promotion gate with discordance δ resolving a gain of ε needs $n \geq z^2\delta/\varepsilon^2$ pairs per domain.

Proof. (i) The two error events differ only on examples whose label is wrong. (ii) Expand $\mathbb{P}[V=1] = r\,t + \varphi(1-t)$. (iii) Normal approximation to the paired binomial. □ □

Consequence. Promotion of a distilled fast-path adapter requires a confidence-bound gain on a verifier that was never used for data collection, plus a per-domain non-regression bound and human sign-off (FR-050–FR-053).

K. What a CPU can serve

Proposition 8 (Decode and prefill ceilings)**.** [exact given the roofline model] *For a dense decoder whose active weights occupy W bytes and whose key–value cache at context length ℓ occupies $K(\ell)$ bytes, the steady-state decode rate on a machine with memory bandwidth β is at most $\beta/(W + K(\ell))$ tokens per second, and the prefill rate on a machine with peak throughput F FLOP/s and P active parameters is at most $F/(2P)$ tokens per second.*

Proof. Each decoded token must stream every active weight and the cache from memory at least once; each prefill token requires at least $2P$ floating-point operations. □ □

Consequence. On the reference machine (dual-channel DDR4-2400, $\beta \approx 38$ GB/s; AVX2, four cores) a 4-billion-parameter model in 4-bit GGUF ($W \approx 2.5$ GB) cannot exceed about 15 tokens/s, a 1.7B model about 35 tokens/s, and a 1000-token prefill of the 4B model takes seconds to tens of seconds. These ceilings fix the model sizes, the thinking-budget cap, the context cap and the prompt-cache requirement (NFR-002–NFR-006). Measured values on the reference machine are reported in Section V-D and are below the ceilings, as expected.

Proposition 9 (Thinking budget)**.** [strong: concave returns] *If $p_2(x,b)$ is concave and non-decreasing in b and the cost is linear, $c_2(x,b) = c_2^0 + \kappa_{tok}\,b$, the budget minimising $L(1 - p_2(x,b)) + \lambda c_2(x,b)$ is the unique $b^\star$ with $L\,\partial_b p_2(x,b^\star) = \lambda\kappa_{tok}$ (or the boundary if no interior solution exists).*

Consequence. The thinking budget is a per-domain configuration value estimated from the Phase-0 accuracy-versus-budget curve (hypothesis H4); when the budget is exhausted the controller forces the answer by closing the reasoning span [51] rather than returning nothing.

L. End-to-end identity

Proposition 10 (Cascade difference)**.** [exact] *Let ρ_1 be the error on tasks the gate keeps and $\bar{e}_2^{kept}$ the error the slow path alone would make on those tasks. If the slow path behaves identically on escalated tasks in both systems, $\mathbb{P}[\text{cascade wrong}] - \mathbb{P}[\text{slow-only wrong}] = (1-g)\big(\rho_1 - \bar{e}_2^{kept}\big)$.*

Consequence. Non-inferiority within m requires $\rho_1 \leq \bar{e}_2^{\text{kept}} + m/(1-g)$; $\bar{e}_2^{\text{kept}}$ is observable only through the audit stream of Proposition 5, which is therefore part of the safety case.

M. Summary of engineering consequences

Table II lists each result with the parameter or algorithm it determines; the specification's traceability matrix repeats the mapping by requirement ID.

IV. Architecture and Design

A. Design Principles

Four principles follow from Section III. (1) *The gate is derived, not tuned*: the controller compares a calibrated error estimate with a cost ratio (Theorem 2). (2) *Acceptance needs evidence*: no answer is marked verified unless an exact verifier accepted it; consensus and judge scores are assurance levels, not proofs (Theorems 1 and 6). (3) *Every loop is bounded*: N, R and the thinking budget are configuration limits enforced by the gateway (Lemma 1). (4) *Self-knowledge is audited*: the self-model is built from traces plus a random audit stream and reports unmeasured capabilities as such (Proposition 5).

TABLE II
FORMAL RESULTS AND WHAT THEY DETERMINE

Result	Engineering consequence
Lemma 1	Hard caps N, R; latency bound
Thm. 1	Verifier (r, φ) publication; exact-verifier threshold 1.0
Thm. 2	Gate = calibrated $\hat{e}_1$, $\hat{e}_2$, cost ratio; no hand-tuned τ
Prop. 1	Calibration-error target of the gate
Prop. 2	Single "speed–care" scalar in the UI
Thm. 3	N from coverage target; measure heterogeneity of a
Prop. 3	R, N from Beta fit and c_p/L_a
Thm. 4	No unverified refinement; $R = 1$ on non-verifiable tasks
Thm. 5	Loop risk $\leq \varphi\,\mathbb{E}[T]$; prompt changes need no new safety case
Thm. 6	Consensus is an assurance flag; N from margin
Prop. 4	Draft-blind slow path; coupling test gate
Prop. 5	5% audit stream; "unmeasured" label
Prop. 6	Phase-0 size $\geq 4\,600$; gate sample sizes
Prop. 7	Promotion gate: held-out verifier, confidence bounds
Prop. 8	Model sizes, context cap, prompt cache, budget cap
Prop. 9	Per-domain thinking budget; budget forcing
Prop. 10	Audit stream is part of the safety case

B. Concept-to-Component Mapping

Fig. 1 gives the mapping. The orchestrator (`nafs-core`) plays al-Ghazali's king: it owns the request and consults the controller. The controller (Aql Gate) plays the vizier: it arbitrates between the fast draft and deliberation on a cost–risk basis. The fast path (System 1) is the impulsive draft; the slow path (System 2) is deliberation; the Verifier Hub supplies external evidence; the Muhasaba Ledger performs the nightly accounting; Tazkiya Distillation is the long-run change of disposition. The gate's cheap features play the role of Avicenna's estimative faculty, a fast particular judgement that is useful and error-prone, which is exactly why it is calibrated and audited.

C. Request Lifecycle

Fig. 2 shows one request and Fig. 3 its state automaton. The Context Manager assembles the prompt from the conversation and any retrieved memory with provenance. System 1 produces a draft in non-thinking mode together with k cheap samples in one request (the `n` parameter of the OpenAI-compatible API, so the prompt is prefilled once). The Aql Gate computes features: mean and minimum token log-probability of the draft, agreement among the k samples, the domain class, and, for verifiable tasks, the verifier outcome on the draft. A calibrated model maps the features to $\hat{e}_1$; the gate escalates if $L(\hat{e}_1 - \hat{e}_2) > \lambda \Delta c$. A verifiable task whose draft fails verification is never eligible for the keep branch (this closes the draft's defect 10, where the router pseudo-code disagreed with its prose). On escalation, System 2 runs draft-blind in thinking mode with budget b and sequential sampling: each

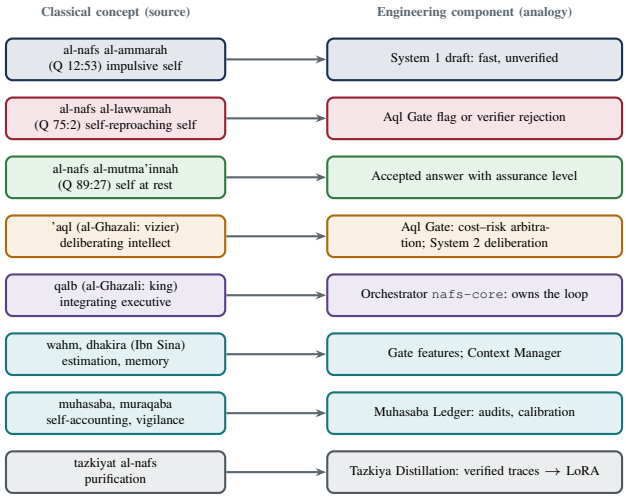


Fig. 1. Concept-to-component mapping. Every arrow is an analogy; component names in code are the engineering names on the right.

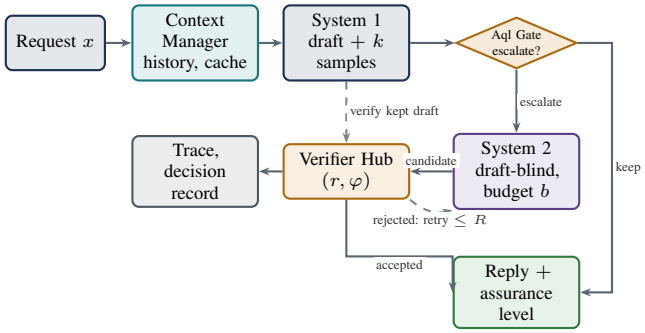
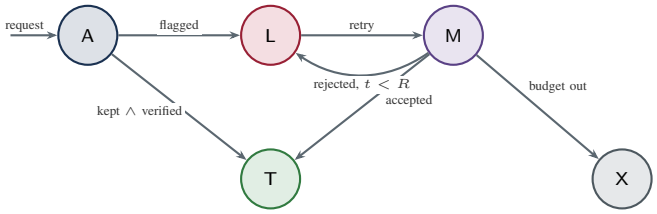


Fig. 2. Request lifecycle. Solid arrows are the main path; dashed arrows are the verification and retry edges.

candidate is verified and the first accepted one is returned; a rejected candidate's evidence (failing test, counterexample, schema error) is fed into the next round, up to R rounds. If the budget is exhausted the reply is an explicit abstention with the best candidate and an uncertainty notice. Every reply carries an *assurance level*: `verified` (exact verifier passed), `consensus` (soft agreement only), `unverified` (kept fast draft on a non-verifiable task) or `abstained`. The decision record of the gate and the trace of the loop are written for the Muhasaba Ledger.

D. Components

- **Rust Gateway (`nafs-gateway`).** HTTP API (OpenAPI 3.1), SSE streaming of tokens and of controller events, WebSocket chat rooms, authentication, rate limits, Prometheus metrics.
- **Orchestrator and Aql Gate (`nafs-core`).** Implements the automaton, the gate, sequential verified sampling, budget forcing, timeouts and fallbacks; emits the decision record.
- **System 1 and System 2 backends.** Two OpenAI-compatible model servers (or one server with two modes in the single-model profile), reached over HTTP with retry and backpressure.



A draft (fast path); L flagged by gate or verifier; M deliberate retry conditioned on verifier evidence; T accepted (assurance level attached); X abstain with uncertainty notice.

Fig. 3. Trace-state automaton of one request. The three Qur'anic stage names are used as mnemonics for A, L and T; the automaton is a bounded retry loop (Lemma 1).

- **Verifier Hub (`nafs-verify`).** Exact verifiers: code sandbox (subprocess with CPU, memory, wall-clock and network limits), numeric and symbolic mathematics (reference-answer equality, SymPy via a sidecar), JSON Schema validation, format checks. Soft verifiers: rubric judge (the System 2 model in non-thinking mode at temperature 0) and sample consensus. Each verifier publishes (r, φ) from mutation tests.
- **Context Manager (`nafs-memory`).** Conversation store (SQLite), prompt assembly within a context cap, prompt-cache affinity hints for the model server, episodic trace store (JSONL), and a retrieval index built with Qwen3-Embedding-0.6B when retrieval is enabled.
- **Muhasaba Ledger.** Offline job that aggregates traces and the 5% audit stream into per-domain calibration tables (escalation rate, $\hat{e}_1$ calibration error, verifier acceptance rates, latency quantiles), keyed by model and adapter hash; feeds the dashboard and the gate's recalibration.
- **Eval Harness (`nafs-eval`) and performance console (`nafs-bench`).** Dataset loaders, metric definitions, paired statistical tests, load generation, and report export.
- **Web UI (`nafs-web`).** Chat room with the assurance level and the reasoning mode visible per message, a performance-test console, and an evaluation dashboard; server-rendered HTML with htmx for streaming updates.
- **Tazkiya Distillation (Python, GPU).** Dataset builder from verified traces, Unsloth LoRA training, promotion gate, GGUF export.

E. Model Profiles

Table III defines three profiles. Profile A is the reference: two dense Qwen3 checkpoints, one per role, chosen because dense grouped-query attention has the most mature CPU kernels, official GGUF files exist, and both are on vLLM's validated CPU list. Profile B serves one switchable Qwen3-4B for both roles, halving resident memory at the price of a slower fast path; the gate then decides *whether to think*, exactly the decision studied by the adaptive-thinking literature. Profile C is the upgrade path to Qwen3.5, which is stronger and multimodal but uses hybrid linear attention whose CPU kernels are newer and, on AVX2 without AVX-512-BF16 or AMX, unaccelerated in vLLM; Phase 0 of the roadmap benchmarks it against Profile A on the target machine before any commitment. The upgrade decision is a go/no-go gate with a measurable criterion.

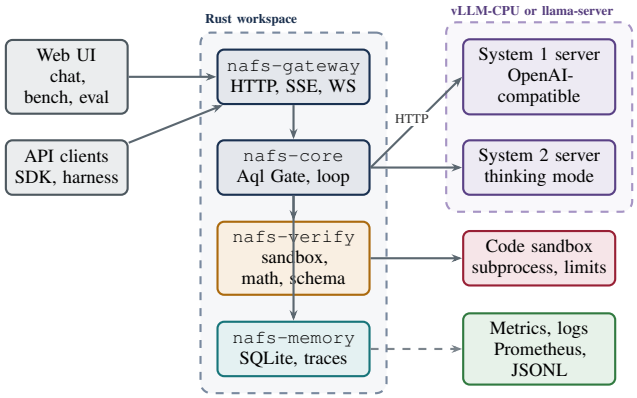


Fig. 4. System architecture, single-node CPU baseline. The GPU scale-out variant replaces the model servers with vLLM on CUDA and keeps every other component unchanged.

TABLE III
MODEL PROFILES (HUGGING FACE IDS VERIFIED 2026-10-18; SIZES ARE GGUF FILE SIZES)

Profile	System 1	System 2
A (ref.)	`Qwen/Qwen3-1.7B`, GGUF Q4_K_M 1.3 GB (`unsloth/Qwen3-1.7B-GGUF`) or Q8_0 1.8 GB (`Qwen/Qwen3-1.7B-GGUF`); thinking off	`Qwen/Qwen3-4B-Thinking-2507`, GGUF Q4_K_M 2.5 GB (`unsloth/Qwen3-4B-Thinking-2507-GGUF`); 262K context
B (min.)	`Qwen/Qwen3-4B` Q4_K_M 2.5 GB (`Qwen/Qwen3-4B-GGUF`), `enable_thinking=false`	same weights, `enable_thinking=true`
C (upgr.)	`Qwen/Qwen3.5-2B` Q4_K_M 1.3 GB (`unsloth/Qwen3.5-2B-GGUF`)	`Qwen/Qwen3.5-4B` Q4_K_M 2.7 GB (`unsloth/Qwen3.5-4B-GGUF`)

Judge: the System 2 model in non-thinking mode. Embeddings: `Qwen/Qwen3-Embedding-0.6B-GGUF` Q8_0. All Apache-2.0. GPU scale-out: the same IDs in BF16 or AWQ under vLLM CUDA, with `Qwen/Qwen3-8B` as the System 2 option.

F. Deployment Topology

The CPU baseline is a single node: one gateway process, one or two model servers pinned to the physical cores (the gateway reserves none, since the gateway's own CPU use is small and bursty), a sandbox runner, SQLite and JSONL on local disk. The model servers are either `llama-server` (macOS or any x86) or vLLM-CPU (Linux, AVX-512 recommended), both behind the same OpenAI-compatible API, so the Rust code has one backend trait and two thin implementations. The optional GPU scale-out variant moves the model servers to vLLM on CUDA with both models resident, raises N and the thinking budget, and enables EAGLE or multi-token-prediction speculative decoding; the gateway, verifiers, memory and UI are unchanged.

G. What Changed from the Draft

The draft's twelve validation results are retained where exact (precision, coverage, cascade cost, router threshold, consensus, value-score algebra, coupling, audit, measurement floors,

distillation noise, capacity, cascade identity) and are restated here with explicit assumptions. We added the miscalibration bound, the frontier proposition, the optimal-stopping cap, the two refinement-loop theorems, the plurality limit, the roofline and the thinking-budget condition. We removed the mapping of the Active Intellect to "external verifiers" and of *ilham* to any component, following the guidance in Section II-A; we replaced the GPU roster with CPU profiles; and we turned the draft's ten defects into requirements with tests in the specification.

V. Implementation Stack

A. Model Serving

vLLM. vLLM [116] is the specified serving layer for the Linux deployment profile. Its x86 CPU backend requires Linux, supports FP32, FP16 and BF16 with AWQ, GPTQ and INT8 W8A8 quantisation, recommends AVX-512 and offers "limited features" on AVX2; pre-built CPU wheels and the `vllm/vllm-openai-cpu` image exist. Qwen3-1.7B, 4B and 8B are on its validated CPU model list. The CPU backend implements hybrid Gated-DeltaNet models, but the accelerated path needs AMX or AVX-512-BF16; elsewhere it falls back to a generic path. At the time of writing the latest published release is v0.31.0 (v0.32.0 is a tag, not a release); the specification pins 0.31.0. vLLM exposes OpenAI-compatible chat completions with `logprobs` and `top_logprobs`, the `n` parameter, a `qwen3` reasoning parser that separates `reasoning_content`, and `chat_template_kwargs` for `enable_thinking`; these are exactly the hooks the gate needs. On the macOS Intel reference machine vLLM runs only inside a Linux container.

llama.cpp. `llama-server` (release v0.7.0, October 2026) is the mandated fallback and the primary engine on the reference machine: GGUF weights, a mature AVX2 path, OpenAI-compatible chat completions with SSE streaming and `logprobs`, `--reasoning-format` to separate reasoning, `--reasoning-budget` for budget forcing, n-gram speculative decoding without a draft model (`--spec-type ngram-simple`), and explicit thread pinning. Both engines present the same HTTP contract, so the Rust gateway has a single backend trait.

Ollama is convenient for demonstrations but its OpenAI endpoint does not return log-probabilities, which the gate requires; it is therefore not a supported backend.

B. Fine-Tuning

Unsloth (2026.10.6) trains with LoRA and QLoRA two to five times faster than baseline PEFT and exports merged weights to GGUF directly. Its core trainer requires a torch accelerator: the device-selection code raises "You need a GPU" on CPU-only hosts, and the documented CPU support covers inference and data preparation, not training. The feasible path is therefore: collect and filter traces on the CPU machine, train on a rented GPU (a 16 GB T4 covers QLoRA on Qwen3-1.7B and 4B [117], [118], and BF16 LoRA on Qwen3.5 up to 4B; Unsloth advises against 4-bit training for Qwen3.5), export GGUF, and run the promotion gate and all evaluation on CPU. Unsloth's default hyperparameters (rank 16–32, $\alpha = r$, learning rate 2×10^{-4}, one to three epochs, effective batch 16, dropout 0, all attention and MLP projections) are the starting point of the training specification.

TABLE IV
Rust crates (versions on crates.io, 2026-10-18)

Crate	Version	Role
tokio	1.53.3	async runtime
axum	0.8.9	HTTP routing, SSE, WebSocket
tower, tower-http	0.5.3, 0.7.1	middleware: timeouts, limits, CORS, compression
hyper	1.12.0	HTTP/1.1 and HTTP/2
reqwest	0.13.5	client to model servers (streaming)
eventsource-stream	0.2.3	SSE parsing of upstream streams
serde, serde_json	1.0.229, 1.0.154	(de)serialisation
schemars	1.2.3	JSON Schema from types
jsonschema	0.59.0	schema verifier
utoipa, utoipa-swagger-ui	6.0.0, 10.0.1	OpenAPI 3.1 generation and docs UI
sqlx	0.9.0	SQLite access, migrations
tracing, tracing-subscriber	0.1.44, 0.3.23	structured logs and spans
opentelemetry, tracing-opentelemetry	0.33.1, 0.34.0	trace export
metrics, metrics-exporter-prometheus	0.24.6, 0.18.3	metrics
askama	0.16.1	HTML templates
clap, figment	4.6.7, 0.10.19	CLI and layered configuration
thiserror, anyhow	2.0.21, 1.0.104	error taxonomy
uuid, chrono	1.28.0, 0.4.45	identifiers, time
governor	0.10.4	rate limiting
criterion, goose	0.8.2, 0.18.1	micro-benchmarks, load tests

C. Rust Web Application

Table IV lists the crates and the versions verified on crates.io on 2026-10-18. **axum** on **tokio** and **tower** is the mainstream, well-maintained choice for an async HTTP service with SSE (`axum::response::Sse`) and WebSockets built in; **reqwest** with `eventsource-stream` consumes the model servers' SSE; **serde** and **schemars** give JSON (de)serialisation and JSON-Schema generation from the same Rust types that the OpenAPI document is generated from with **utoipa**; **sqlx** with SQLite gives compile-time-checked queries without a database server; **tracing** with OpenTelemetry export and **metrics-exporter-prometheus** provide observability; **askama** templates with **htmx** keep the front end server-rendered and dependency-light (a single-page framework such as Leptos is an option for a later phase, not a requirement); **goose** provides load generation for the performance console and **criterion** micro-benchmarks. The toolchain is pinned to the stable release current at project start (1.96 on the reference machine; 1.99 is current upstream).

D. Reference Machine and Measured Feasibility

The reference machine is an Intel Core i3-8100 (four cores, no simultaneous multithreading, AVX2 and FMA, no AVX-512), 32 GB of DDR4, macOS 15.4.1. We built llama.cpp from source (commit `797de63`, 2026-10-17) and ran `llama-bench` with four threads, 512-token prefill and 128-token decode, three repetitions. Table V reports the results. The Qwen3-1.7B decode rate of 15.5 tokens/s against a 1.26 GiB weight file implies an effective bandwidth of

TABLE V
MEASURED THROUGHPUT ON THE REFERENCE MACHINE (LLAMA.CPP, 4 THREADS; MEAN ± S.D. OVER 3 RUNS)

Model (GGUF)	Size	Prefill tok/s	Decode tok/s
Qwen3-0.6B Q8_0	604 MiB	180.6 ± 2.4	32.6 ± 1.8
Qwen3-1.7B Q4_K_M	1.26 GiB	94.1 ± 9.5	15.5 ± 3.4
Qwen3-4B Q4_K_M	2.32 GiB	38.2 ± 0.6	6.7 ± 0.8
Qwen3-4B-Thinking-2507 Q4_K_M	2.32 GiB	38.4 ± 1.5	7.0 ± 0.9

about 20 GB/s, roughly half the theoretical 38.4 GB/s of dual-channel DDR4-2400, which is in line with the roofline of Proposition 8 and with published AVX2 data points. We also confirmed, through Ollama, that Qwen3-1.7B generates in both thinking and non-thinking modes on this machine; a 512-token thinking cap was exhausted on a simple arithmetic question before the answer was produced, which is the empirical reason the controller forces the answer when the budget is reached (Proposition 9). We also exercised `llama-server` through its OpenAI-compatible API with Qwen3-1.7B: per-token log-probabilities are returned with `logprobs`; the `n` parameter is capped by the number of server slots, so the gate's k cheap samples are issued as k parallel requests against k slots (four 12-token samples completed in 3.0 s with 47 of 48 prompt tokens served from the prompt cache); `enable_thinking` toggles the mode per request; `-reasoning-budget 256` closed the reasoning span after 256 tokens and the model then produced an answer; and SSE streaming delivered chunked deltas. These are the exact hooks the specification relies on. We did not run vLLM on the reference machine because the Docker daemon was not running; the specification's vLLM configuration is taken from its documentation and is marked as untested on this machine.

From these measurements and the roofline we derive the CPU-baseline targets of the specification: a fast-path first token under two seconds for prompts up to 1 000 tokens with prompt caching, a fast-path reply of 150 tokens in about ten seconds, and a slow-path reply with a 1 024-token thinking budget on the 4B model in about two to three minutes; the latter is acceptable for a demonstration and for batch evaluation, and is the reason the roadmap keeps interactive use of System 2 optional until the GPU variant exists.

VI. FEATURES AND CAPABILITIES

- **Dual-process chat.** Every reply shows which path produced it, the assurance level, the thinking budget used and the cost; the user can move a single "speed–care" control, which sets λ (Proposition 2).
- **Verified answers on code, mathematics and structured output**, with precision bounded by the verifier (Theorem 1), and evidence-fed retries (Theorem 5).
- **Calibrated abstention.** When the budget is exhausted the system says so, returns the best candidate with an uncertainty notice, and never upgrades consensus to verification (Theorem 6).
- **Honest self-description.** A per-domain capability table from audited traces, with unmeasured domains marked as such (Proposition 5).
- **Performance console.** Load tests against the gateway with latency quantiles, throughput, escalation rate and cost per request, run from the browser.
- **Evaluation dashboard.** Benchmark runs with paired comparisons against the fast-only and slow-only baselines, confidence intervals, routing accuracy and calibration plots, and the go/no-go status of each roadmap gate.
- **Gradual distillation.** Verified slow-path traces become training data for the fast path under a statistically sized promotion gate with human sign-off (Proposition 7).
- **Backend portability.** The same gateway runs against llama-server on a laptop and vLLM on a server, CPU or GPU.

Honest limits: non-verifiable domains never exceed the `consensus` assurance level; the fast and slow paths share a model family, so their errors are correlated and the collision term of Proposition 4 is measured, not assumed small; on the reference machine the slow path is not interactive.

VII. SPECIFICATION AND ROADMAP SUMMARY

The companion *Technical Specification* and *Development Roadmap* are standalone documents built from the same sources as this report; this section summarises them so that the report is self-contained.

A. Specification

The specification uses RFC 2119 keywords and gives every requirement an identifier: functional (FR), non-functional (NFR), interface (IF), model (MR), training (TR), security (SR), operations (OR) and evaluation (ER). The requirement catalogue has 99 entries; each is traced to the result or design decision that motivates it, to the component that implements it and to the test that verifies it. Key normative content:

- **Gate (FR-010–FR-014).** The controller MUST compute the decision of Theorem 2 from a calibrated estimator and a configured cost ratio, MUST never keep a verifiable draft that failed verification, and MUST write a decision record with the features, estimates and thresholds used.
- **Deliberation (FR-020–FR-024).** Sequential verified sampling with configured caps N, R and budget b per domain derived from the Phase-0 fit; draft-blind by default; budget forcing on exhaustion; abstention with notice.
- **Verification (FR-030–FR-033).** Exact verifiers accept at threshold 1.0; every verifier publishes (r, φ); assurance levels are attached to every reply; consensus never writes training data.
- **Self-model (FR-040–FR-042).** A 5% audit stream; unmeasured capabilities reported as unmeasured; statistics keyed by model and adapter hash.
- **Distillation (TR-001–TR-008).** Data schema, filtering, Unsloth LoRA configuration, GPU path, promotion gate with confidence bounds and held-out verifier, human sign-off, GGUF export.
- **Targets (NFR-001–NFR-012).** Hard latency bound from Lemma 1; fast-path first token under two seconds and 150-token reply within twelve seconds at p95 on the reference machine; resident memory under 8 GB for Profile A; reproducible builds; structured telemetry. All targets are labelled as targets.

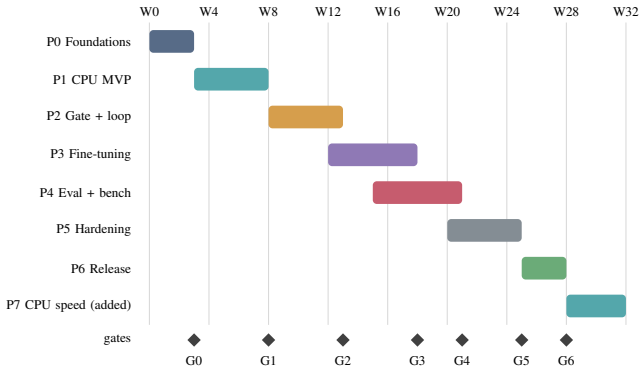


Fig. 5. Roadmap timeline (weeks; estimates). Diamonds are decision gates G0–G6 with go/no-go criteria defined in the roadmap document.

- **Interfaces (IF-001–IF-010).** OpenAPI 3.1 for the gateway with SSE streaming and a `reasoning_mode` field on every reply; JSON Schemas for the request, reply, decision record and trace; the backend contract to vLLM and llama-server with retry, timeout and backpressure policy.

Machine-readable artefacts accompany the document: `openapi.yaml`, JSON Schemas, a sample vLLM launch configuration and llama-server command, a Cargo workspace skeleton and a sample configuration file, all validated with standard tools.

B. Roadmap

Fig. 5 shows the seven phases and their gates; effort and dates are estimates. Phase 0 (foundations, weeks 0–3) delivers the serving baseline on the reference machine and the 4 600-task measurement run. Phase 1 (CPU MVP, weeks 3–8) delivers the gateway, both paths behind a fixed-rule gate, the chat UI and the minimal verifier hub, which is the smallest build that demonstrates the idea end to end. Phase 2 (gate and loop, weeks 8–13) replaces the fixed rule with the calibrated gate and adds the verified retry loop and the audit stream; its exit gate is the non-inferiority test at three points. Phase 3 (fine-tuning, weeks 12–18) runs the first distillation cycle on a rented GPU under the promotion gate. Phase 4 (evaluation suite and performance console, weeks 15–21) completes the dashboard and the load tests. Phase 5 (hardening and optional GPU scale-out, weeks 20–25) adds security hardening, the vLLM CUDA profile and the Qwen3.5 upgrade decision. Phase 6 (release and publication, weeks 25–28) delivers the one-point non-inferiority gate, documentation and the research write-up. Phase 7 (CPU inference performance, added after the first six phases were implemented) attributes latency to stages, tunes the engine under interleaved A/B tests, adds early escalation, and prepares EAGLE-3 speculative heads and repacked weight formats. The MVP is specified with acceptance tests; every phase has measurable entry and exit criteria, a risk register with early-warning signals, and a research-to-engineering table that schedules hypotheses H1–H7.

VIII. Evaluation Plan and Metrics

No result in this section has been measured; the section defines what will be measured, how, and what counts as success. The full definitions, formulas and test plans are in the specification (Section 10 there).

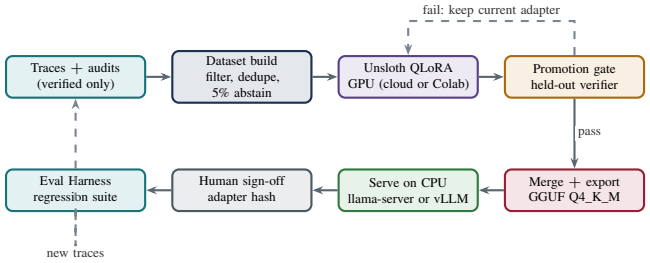


Fig. 6. Training and serving pipeline. Training runs on a rented GPU; everything else runs on CPU.

A. Metrics

- **Quality.** Exact-match or test-pass accuracy on verifiable benchmarks; pairwise win rate against the slow-only baseline by a held-out judge on non-verifiable prompts; abstention rate and accuracy among non-abstained answers (selective accuracy at coverage).
- **Routing.** Escalation rate g; routing accuracy, defined as the fraction of requests on which the gate's decision agrees with the oracle decision of Theorem 2 computed from labelled outcomes; the area under the cost–accuracy curve as λ varies (Proposition 2).
- **Cost and latency.** Tokens and CPU-seconds per request by path; time to first token and total latency at p50, p95 and p99; throughput under load.
- **Calibration.** Expected calibration error of $\hat{e}_1$ with five bins and $n \geq 2\,900$ (the noise floor of a ten-bin estimate at $n = 500$ is 0.034, above the target), and Brier score.
- **Verifier quality.** (r, φ) per verifier from mutation tests, with Clopper–Pearson intervals [114].
- **Faithfulness.** Agreement between the reasoning trace and the answer on perturbation tests [119], [120], and adoption rate of a wrong fast draft by the slow path (Proposition 4).
- **Robustness.** Accuracy under paraphrase and under prompt injection probes [121]–[123].

B. Benchmarks

GSM8K [47] and MATH [124] (mathematics, exact verifiers), HumanEval [125] and MBPP [126] (code, test verifiers), a JSON-Schema task set generated from public schemas (format verifier), MMLU and GPQA [127], [128] (knowledge, label verifier), TruthfulQA and SimpleQA [129], [130] (factuality), BIG-Bench Hard [131] and LiveCodeBench [132] as contamination-resistant checks, and MT-Bench style judged conversations [133]. Licences are MIT, Apache-2.0 or CC-BY-4.0 (GPQA is gated). Public routing data from RouteLLM [73] seeds the gate's calibration set.

C. Protocol

Phase 0 runs the fast-only and slow-only baselines on at least 4 600 tasks across domains (Proposition 6) to estimate q, (r, φ), $e_1(s)$, $e_2(s)$, the cost ratio and the discordance rate.

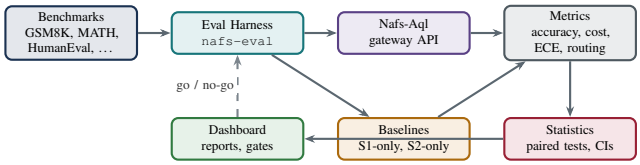


Fig. 7. Evaluation workflow. The harness drives the system and the two baselines through the same API and the dashboard shows gate status.

Every later comparison is paired on the same tasks, reports the difference with a 95% confidence interval, and uses a non-inferiority margin of three points (about 700 pairs) during development and one point (about 6 200 pairs) for release. Gates for rates that must be below a threshold use the zero-failure binomial rule or the Clopper–Pearson upper bound. Drift in the self-model is monitored with a CUSUM chart [134] and a negative control. Multiple comparisons across five domains use a Bonferroni-corrected $z = 2.326$.

D. Hypotheses Scheduled for Validation

H1: the calibrated gate achieves at least 70% routing accuracy against the oracle at $g \leq 0.3$ (Phase 2). H2: at matched accuracy the cascade costs at most 60% of the slow-only baseline on the Phase-0 suite (Phase 2). H3: per-task acceptance rates are adequately fitted by a Beta distribution per domain, judged by a goodness-of-fit test (Phase 2). H4: slow-path accuracy is concave in the thinking budget on each domain (Phase 0). H5: the draft-blind slow path adopts a wrong fast draft in fewer than 5% of trials at 95% confidence over at least 200 trials (Phase 2). H6: one round of distillation yields a lower-confidence-bound gain above zero on a held-out verifier without a per-domain regression beyond one point (Phase 3). H7: Qwen3.5 hybrid models decode at no less than 70% of the speed of same-size dense Qwen3 models on the target CPU (Phase 0, gate for Profile C).

IX. Implementation and Measured Results

This section reports the system as built and what it measured, as of 18 October 2026. Phases 0–6 of the roadmap are implemented on the CPU reference machine, and a Phase 7 on CPU inference performance was added (Section IX-D). GPU training and GPU scale-out were deferred. Every number below is generated by `scripts/gen_publication.py` from stored runs and evidence files. The machine was shared with other workloads (load average 6–18), so absolute speeds are lower bounds and small effects are within noise. Sample sizes are far below the release gates of Section VIII, so the results are indicative.

A. The system as built

The Rust workspace has eight crates: the gateway (axum), the orchestrator (`nafs-core`), verifiers with a sandbox, memory (SQLite, BM25 retrieval), evaluation and statistics, load testing, the shared types, and an embedded web interface. The gateway serves 50 documented endpoints (OpenAPI 1.5) and an OpenAI-compatible chat API. System 1 is Qwen3-1.7B and System 2 Qwen3-4B-Thinking-2507, both in Q4_K_M on llama-server; a vLLM-CPU profile runs the same API in a Linux VM or container.

The web interface (Fig. 8) has seven pages:

- **Chat:** streaming answers with the automaton strip (A → L → M → T/X), assurance badges, a one-line reason from the gate, an inspector with the decision record and a per-stage latency waterfall, and "Both" trials in which a person compares the System 1 and System 2 answers;
- **Lab:** experiment presets, paired statistics, the roadmap gates and a pooled policy map;
- **Muhasaba:** gate mode and calibration, verifier quality, the capability ledger, drift and alerts;
- **Tazkiya:** distillation readiness, the review queue and the model registry;
- **Rooms**, **Performance** and **System**.

B. The laboratory

The Lab treats each way of combining the two systems as a *policy* and runs them on identical tasks:

- fast only and deliberate only;
- the gate with the verifier visible, and the gate routing on its own estimate ("blind");
- a draft-conditioned ablation;
- thinking-budget and λ sweeps.

Paired differences carry bootstrap intervals, exact McNemar tests and Bonferroni correction. The *policy map* (Fig. 9) pools every stored run and, for each domain and each price of latency λ, names the policy with the lowest expected loss $L(1-\mathrm{acc})+\lambda c$. Over the 6 stored runs the best policy is, per domain: code: the gate with the verifier for $\lambda \leq 0.1$, System 1 alone for $\lambda \geq 0.2$; math: the gate with the verifier for $\lambda \leq 0.1$, System 1 alone for $\lambda \geq 0.2$; structured: the gate with the verifier at every λ. Below a price of about 0.1 per minute of waiting, deliberation pays for its time on code and mathematics. Above it, the fast path wins, because the verifier already catches most of its errors.

C. Policies, verifiers and model choice

Table VI shows one scaled run of five policies (run `7ffd4442`). With the verifier visible, the gate matched deliberate-only accuracy at 0.36 of its cost. With the verifier hidden, the uncalibrated gate routed correctly on only 50% of items, because cheap samples agreed with wrong drafts: agreement is a flag, not evidence (Theorem 6).

Table VII gives the verifiers' measured true- and false-accept rates (runs `de66e962`, `f7991b65`, `50ff0d27`, `fd07e0a8`, `dc7168b0`). Mathematics meets the $\varphi \leq 0.01$ target. The code φ is an upper bound inflated by behaviourally equivalent mutants.

The Profile C decision (MR-005) compared Qwen3.5-2B with Qwen3-1.7B as System 1 on 30 tasks, in alternating order and with the production prompt (Table VIII). Qwen3.5-2B was more accurate (+17 points, 95% CI [+7, +30], $n = 30$), but about 3.7 times slower per task under load. The adoption rule requires latency within 1.3 times, so Profile A stays the default. The accuracy gain is recorded for a faster host.

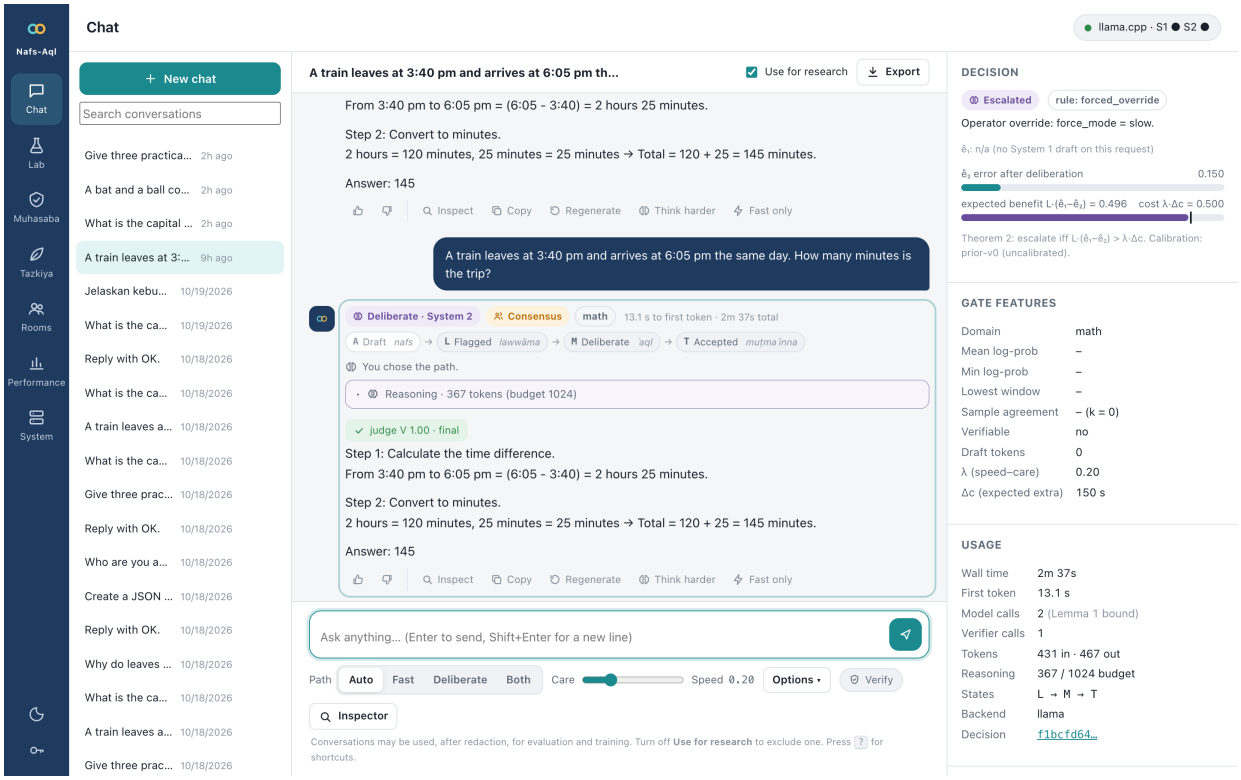


Fig. 8. Chat page (measured system). A code answer passed the exact verifier on the draft, so the gate kept it (Theorem 1); the inspector shows the decision, the gate features and the usage.

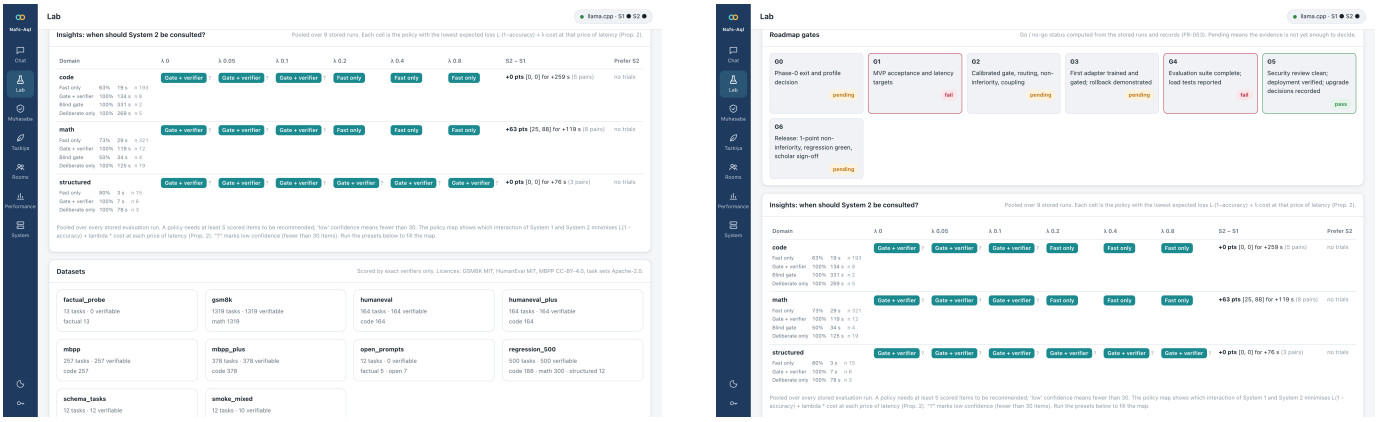


Fig. 9. Lab page: the pooled policy map, answering "when should System 2 be consulted?" per domain and price of latency (left); roadmap gates G0–G6 evaluated from stored evidence (right).

TABLE VI
POLICIES ON A MIXED TASK SET (RUN 7FFD4442)

System	n	Acc.	95% CI	Esc.	Wall (s)
fast_only	6	67%	[22%, 96%]	0%	13
nafs_aql	6	100%	[54%, 100%]	33%	96
nafs_blind	6	67%	[22%, 96%]	17%	133
slow_conditioned	6	100%	[54%, 100%]	100%	319
slow_only	6	100%	[54%, 100%]	100%	264

TABLE VII
VERIFIER QUALITY: r FROM CORRECT ANSWERS, φ FROM SEEDED MUTANTS

Verifier	Correct	r	Mutants	φ	φ upper
code_tests	364	0.995	754	0.109	0.133
json_schema	24	1.000	53	0.000	0.067
judge	23	1.000	22	0.045	0.228
math_numeric	2000	1.000	2800	0.000	0.001

D. CPU inference performance (Phase 7)

Where the time goes. Every reply now records its stages:

- retrieval, the System 1 draft, the cheap samples, verification, System 2 deliberation and the judge;
- for each model stage, the gateway queue wait and llama-

TABLE VIII
PROFILE C DECISION (SYSTEM 1 CANDIDATES, 30 TASKS)

System 1	All	Math	Code	JSON	Wall (s)	tok/s
Qwen3-1.7B (Profile A)	67%	56%	75%	83%	24.0	4.3
Qwen3.5-2B (Profile C)	83%	81%	75%	100%	88.9	1.9

TABLE IX
LATENCY BY STAGE (SHARE OF WALL TIME)

Path (replies)	Stage	Share	p50 (s)	p95 (s)
fast (475)	System 1 draft	98%	13.6	56.1
fast (475)	verify draft	2%	0.2	0.9
deliberate (39)	System 2 deliberation	95%	120.6	424.1
deliberate (39)	judge	3%	40.0	44.3
deliberate (39)	System 1 draft	2%	9.2	59.2
deliberate (39)	probe	1%	1.5	6.4

server's own prefill time, decode time and KV-cache reuse. Over 514 replies with stage timings, the fast path spends essentially all of its time in the System 1 draft, and the deliberate path in System 2 deliberation (Table IX, Fig. 10); verification and gating are negligible. The prompt cache already serves most prompt tokens (Table X), so prefill is small. *Decode speed is the bottleneck*, and it falls several-fold when other workloads share the four cores: 2.6–4.3 tokens/s in service, against 22.9 in an idle llama-bench run.

Techniques and their measured effect. Each change was accepted only after an interleaved A/B on the reference machine (NFR-031):

- *Skipping cheap samples when an exact verifier decides* (Theorem 1 makes them irrelevant): median draft time fell from 13.4 s to 7.9 s.
- *Prompt-cache warm-up* at start-up, with llama-server's host-memory prompt cache: a cold first request had 9.8 s time to first token, a warm one about 1 s.
- *Verifier warm-up*: the first verification after start-up fell from 0.45 s to 3 ms.
- *Early escalation* (FR-080): under the fixed rule, an open-ended draft whose running mean log-prob is already below the threshold minus a margin is stopped and handed to System 2, instead of being generated to the end, in the spirit of cost-aware cascades [74], [75]. In the agreement study, on 40 open-ended prompts, the configured rule ($N = 32$, margin 0.04) agreed with the full-draft decision on 100% of prompts, caught 3 of 10 escalations early and saved 116 draft tokens per early escalation (Table XI).
- *Sequential, uncertainty-gated samples*: the two agreement samples had run concurrently with the draft, and three sequences on four cores tripled the factual fast path (12.6 s median, 1.4 s to first token). They are now drawn after the draft and only when its mean log-prob lies within 0.10 of the threshold; the path is 4.3 s and 0.14 s, the same as drawing no samples.
- *Four System 1 slots*: four sessions no longer queue behind three; batched decode makes the fourth slot cheap.
- *No gain*, so not adopted:
  - speculative decoding [84] with a 0.6B draft model (6.5 against 7.3 tokens/s), because the draft model competes for the same cores and memory bandwidth;
  - n-gram lookup;
  - flash attention and a q8_0 KV cache: a sequential run suggested a 30% gain, which an interleaved repeat showed to be an ordering effect of the shared load.

TABLE X
ENGINE SPEED PER MODEL STAGE (LLAMA-SERVER TIMINGS)

Model stage	Calls	Prefill tok/s	Decode tok/s	Cache reuse
System 1 draft	485	53	7.0	60%
cheap samples	32	13	4.2	80%
System 2 deliberation	45	16	3.4	95%

TABLE XI
EARLY-ESCALATION AGREEMENT STUDY (OPEN-ENDED PROMPTS)

N	Margin	Agreement	Caught	False	Saved tok/esc.
32	0.00	80%	10/10	8	82
32	0.02	95%	5/10	2	92
32	0.04	100%	3/10	0	116
32	0.15	100%	0/10	0	0
48	0.00	90%	9/10	4	77
48	0.02	98%	4/10	1	117
48	0.04	100%	2/10	0	154
48	0.15	100%	0/10	0	0

Concurrency. The load-test protocol (latest run `6c462074`, Table XII) gave a 4-session p95 of 1.25 times the single-session value. The gate judges NFR-007 on the median over recent eligible runs (median ratio 2.15 over 3 run(s) (1.25, 2.15, 2.48); fallback: document the single-session profile), because single runs on the shared host ranged from 1.25 to 2.48.

Adaptive reasoning exit (FR-082). The deliberate path is almost entirely System 2 reasoning, so the second Phase 7 change shortens the reasoning itself, in the spirit of the 2026 early-exit methods (DTSR, DEER, Dynasor-CoT) but with the design's own stopping signal. System 2 reasons in chunks on llama-server's raw continuation endpoint, which keeps the prefix cached. At a reflection signal ("Wait", "Alternatively", ...), with a minimum gap of 64 tokens and at the latest every 256 tokens, the reasoning is closed provisionally and the model is asked for its answer in a few tokens. On a verifiable task the exact verifier judges that probe and, if it passes, the reasoning stops; on factual tasks two consecutive agreeing probes stop it. The final answer is then generated after the reasoning exactly as on the standard path, so the exit changes only how much reasoning is generated, and the exit reason is recorded with the reply. A probe costs 0.6–0.8 s. In the paired Lab comparison (run `e7607cbb`), with the exit: accuracy 100%, mean wall 123 s; without: 100%, 220 s ($n = 11$ GSM8K items; paired Δ accuracy +0 points, 95% CI [+0, +0]).

EAGLE-3 speculative heads [87] for both models (AngelSlim, Apache-2.0) were converted and measured in interleaved A/B runs (Table XIII). On a GPU these heads give 1.7× because verifying a draft is nearly free there. On four cores the verification pass costs real compute, and at the measured acceptance of about half the drafted tokens neither system gained: System 1 1.04× greedy and 0.95× at the production

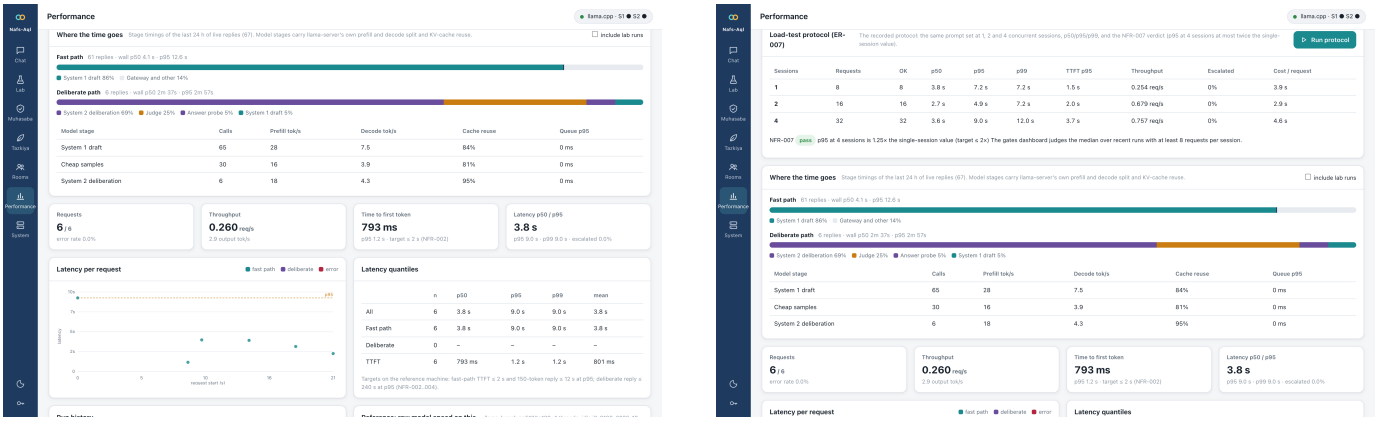


Fig. 10. Performance page: where the time goes, from stage timings, with the engine's prefill and decode speed and cache reuse (left); the load-test protocol at 1, 2 and 4 sessions with the NFR-007 verdict (right).

TABLE XII
LOAD-TEST PROTOCOL, FAST PATH (RUN `6c462074`)

Sessions	p50 (s)	p95 (s)	p99 (s)	req/s
1	3.8	7.2	7.2	0.25
2	2.7	4.9	7.2	0.68
4	3.6	9.0	12.0	0.76

TABLE XIII
EAGLE-3 SPECULATIVE DECODING, INTERLEAVED A/B ON THE REFERENCE CPU

Model	Variant	Sampling	Decode tok/s	Speed-up	Drafted tokens accepted
System 1	plain	greedy	17.3	1.00	–
System 1	plain	production	18.0	1.00	–
System 1	eagle3_n4	greedy	18.0	1.04	52%
System 1	eagle3_n4	production	17.2	0.95	49%
System 1	eagle3_n8	greedy	16.0	0.93	46%
System 1	eagle3_n8	production	15.4	0.86	42%
System 2	plain	greedy	8.3	1.00	–
System 2	plain	production	7.6	1.00	–
System 2	eagle3_n4	greedy	8.2	0.99	46%
System 2	eagle3_n4	production	7.5	0.99	46%
System 2	eagle3_n8	greedy	7.3	0.87	37%
System 2	eagle3_n8	production	6.9	0.91	37%

temperature, System 2 0.99× on reasoning prompts; eight draft tokens were slower than no speculation on both. The heads stay available as an opt-in (`EAGLE=1`) for a host with more cores. Weight formats with AVX2 repack kernels (Q4_0, IQ4_NL) remain to be measured the same way.

Weight formats. Q4_0 and IQ4_NL use llama.cpp's AVX2 repack kernels, which read the weights in an interleaved layout; Table XIV compares them with the production Q4_K_M on the same model (interleaved `llama-bench` runs, 4 threads, host load recorded in the log).

A smaller judge? The rubric judge is the largest fixed cost on open questions once the adaptive exit is in place (26–40 s per answer on System 2). Scoring with System 1 instead would be about three times faster, so it was measured with the rates harness on the same labelled items: System 2 judge: $r = 1.00$, $\varphi = 0.045$ (upper 0.23); System 1 judge: $r = 0.78$, $\varphi = 0.27$ (upper 0.50); 23 correct and 22 seeded wrong answers. A judge that accepts a quarter of the seeded wrong answers is not a soft verifier in the sense of Theorem 1, so the judge stays on System 2; the backend remains a configuration option for hosts with a larger small model.

TABLE XIV
WEIGHT FORMATS, QWEN3-1.7B, LLAMA-BENCH PP128/TG64

Weights (Qwen3-1.7B)	Prefill tok/s	Decode tok/s
Qwen3-1.7B-Q4_K_M	81	15.3
Qwen3-1.7B-Q4_0 (own)	44	12.2
Qwen3-1.7B-IQ4_NL (own)	70	16.0
Qwen3-1.7B-Q4_K_M (own)	72	12.8

vLLM backend. The second serving profile, vLLM's CPU backend, now runs in Docker from the team's `carstenz/vllm-smoke` image (vLLM 0.30, x86 CPU build) with Qwen3-1.7B serving both roles from the host's Hugging Face weights, and the gateway switches between the two backend sets at run time. Two facts shaped the recipe. First, the Docker VM exposes AVX2 only, where oneDNN has no BF16 kernels: in BF16 the engine loaded but never returned a token, so the model runs in FP32 (6.8 GB of weights). Second, the VM's memory cap matters: at 6 GiB only 0.18 GiB remained for the KV cache and at 10 GiB with a 2 048-token context the engine was OOM-killed during its profiling pass, so the context, the prefill batch and the KV cache are kept small. The gateway-side check, which drives every request path the orchestrator depends on against the backend, reports no result yet: on the day of the work the host had under 1 GB free and the Docker VM did not start at the 7.5 GiB the stand-in needs. On four shared cores the three-vCPU VM is a correctness and portability profile, not a speed contest with llama-server.

E. Operations and the gates

Monitoring and safety:

- **Drift and alerts** (Fig. 11): a two-sided CUSUM per domain on calibration error and fast-path accuracy, with a shuffled negative control. Five alert rules run over live traffic only; evaluation and load-test replies are tagged as lab traffic.
- **Security:** 26/26 security tests pass; 0 open high-severity findings. The suite found one high-severity issue, now fixed: sandboxed code could signal other processes.

- **Deployment checks:** 11 passed, 0 failed, 1 skipped (tool or host not available).

Table XV lists the roadmap gates as evaluated from stored evidence. The gates that remain pending need release-scale runs (thousands of paired items), GPU training, or the scholar review of the analogy text.

X. Phase 8: Quantum Consciousness, Neuroscience and Sequential Evidence

Phase 8 (20 October 2026) asked whether quantum theories of consciousness and the neuroscience of decision making offer improvements to the inference speed or the reasoning accuracy of Nafs-Aql. Each candidate idea had to pass four tests before any code was written: it must be established rather than hypothesised; a classical, CPU-only pipeline must inherit something from it beyond its classical description; it must yield a result with an engineering consequence in the sense of Section III; and the consequence must be measurable on the reference machine with the exact verifiers. The full review, with sources, is `docs/research/quantum_neuro_review.md`; this section records the results.

A. Quantum consciousness: a negative result

Orchestrated objective reduction [135] places consciousness in quantum computations within microtubules. Tegmark's estimate of the decoherence times of the relevant superpositions is 10^{-20}–10^{-13} s against dynamical timescales of 10^{-3}–10^{-1} s [136]; the rebuttal of [137] lengthens the former by several orders of magnitude without reaching the latter. Recent measurements of collective ultraviolet emission from tryptophan networks in microtubules [138] show a modest quantum-yield enhancement and do not demonstrate computation. Two results close the question for Nafs-Aql.

Proposition 11 (Decoherence separation)**.** [literature] *With $\tau_{\mathrm{dec}} \le 10^{-4}$ s on the most favourable published estimate and $\tau_{\mathrm{dyn}} \ge 10^{-3}$ s, any superposition of neural states has decohered into a mixture over the interval of a decision. The description of cognition at that timescale is a classical stochastic process.*

Consequence. The object is the one Section III already models: stochastic policies π_1, π_2 and a finite automaton over trace states.

Proposition 12 (No transferable algorithm)**.** [exact] *A classical machine that follows the state of n two-level systems stores 2^n complex amplitudes; in double precision the reference machine's 32 GB hold $n \le 30$. No theorem separates BQP from BPP, so no speed-up is inherited by a classical algorithm from the quantum character of a process.*

Proof. $\dim \mathbb{C}^{2^n} = 2^n$ and $2^{30} \times 16$ bytes $= 17$ GB; the second claim is the open status of the separation. □ □

Consequence. Even an established Orch OR would contribute nothing computable to a CPU inference loop (A-055). Quantum *cognition*, the use of Hilbert-space probability as a descriptive model of judgement [139], [140], has one structural lesson: non-commuting measurements produce order effects, confirmed by the parameter-free QQ equality on about seventy surveys [141], [142] and reported in language models [143]. Read for Nafs-Aql, an order effect is anchoring of the deliberate answer on the draft, which the draft-blind slow path (FR-023) removes and the coupling test (ER-004) measures (Proposition 4). The design needed no change.

B. Neuroscience: the sequential form of the gate

Three results of decision neuroscience have exact mathematical forms: evidence is accumulated to a bound [144], whose optimal form is Wald's sequential probability ratio test [145], [146]; under a cost of time or a deadline the optimal bound collapses [147], [148]; and the quality of a confidence signal is its accuracy–confidence association measured by ROC statistics [149], with the all-or-none ignition of a global workspace as the same threshold picture at system level [150]. Theorem 2 is the one-step instance; three mechanisms of Nafs-Aql read a *stream* of evidence and stop on a bound, and each had a hand-set rule where a theorem exists. The language-model literature reached the same rules independently [151]–[153].

Proposition 13 (ROC dominance)**.** [exact] *If the ROC curve of a confidence signal s' for predicting a wrong draft dominates that of s at every escalation rate, the best threshold gate on s' has an objective* (1) *no larger than the best threshold gate on s, for every L, λ and Δc.*

Proof. At a fixed escalation rate the compute term is equal and the error term is L times the wrong drafts not escalated, which dominance makes no larger; minimising over the rate preserves the inequality. □ □

Consequence. The gate's signal is chosen by a stored ROC study against exact labels (ER-021), not by convention.

Proposition 14 (Exact early escalation on a running minimum)**.** [exact] *Let $w(n)$ be the lowest mean log-probability over complete windows of W consecutive tokens among the first n tokens of a draft. Then w is non-increasing in n, so for the rule "escalate iff $w(N) < \theta$" the stopping time $T = \min\{n : w(n) < \theta\}$ gives exactly the full draft's decision, and no rule on the same stream escalates such a draft earlier without a non-zero disagreement rate.*

Proof. A minimum over a growing set; $w(N) \le w(T) < \theta$; before T every window is $\ge \theta$. □ □

Consequence. Early escalation on the lowest-window signal needs no margin, minimum token count or agreement study (FR-083). It is a decision, not a prediction.

Proposition 15 (Wald's bound on the mean rule)**.** [exact under i.i.d. Gaussian tokens] *Any sequential test of $\mu = \tau$ against $\mu = \tau - \delta$ on tokens with variance σ^2 and errors (α, β) has $\mathbb{E}_1[N] \ge \big[(1-\beta)\ln\frac{1-\beta}{\alpha} + \beta\ln\frac{\beta}{1-\alpha}\big] \big/ \frac{\delta^2}{2\sigma^2}$.*

Measured. On the 40 open-ended drafts of the early-escalation study the per-token spread is $\sigma \approx 0.28$ and the

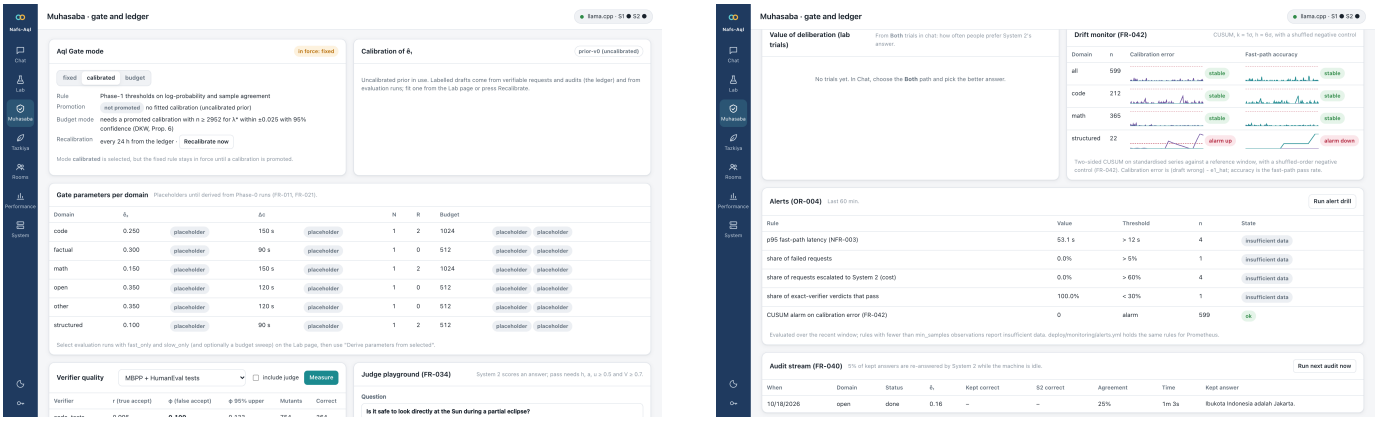


Fig. 11. Muhasaba page: gate mode, promotion status and calibration (left); drift monitor and alert rules over live traffic (right).

TABLE XV
ROADMAP GATES EVALUATED FROM STORED EVIDENCE (18 OCTOBER 2026)

Gate	Status	Evidence
G0	pending	H7: pass; P0-T04: pending
G1	fail	MVP: fail; NFR-002/004: fail
G2	pending	ECE: pending; H1: pending; ER-002: pending; ER-004: pending
G3	pending	TR-007: pending; OR-005: pending
G4	fail	P4: pass; ER-007: pass; NFR-007: fail
G5	pass	SR-006/SR-002: pass; OR-003: pass; MR-005: pass
G6	pending	ER-002: pending; ER-008: pass; SR-005: pending

margin is $\delta = 0.04$: the bound is 260 tokens at $\alpha = \beta = 0.05$, against drafts of 47–291 tokens (median 133), and the first tokens of a draft are systematically more confident than the rest. *Consequence.* The mean-based early escalation of P7-T03 is an empirical heuristic that cannot be made more aggressive by a sequential test; it is kept at its measured setting and labelled as such (A-056).

Proposition 16 (Posterior stopping with a collapsing bound)**.** [exact for the rule; strong for optimality] *With k probed answers clustered into categories, counts v and a uniform Dirichlet prior, the posterior probability that the plurality answer is the majority answer is $1 - I_{1/2}(v_{\text{top}} + 1,\, k - v_{\text{top}} + 1) = 1 - 2^{-k-1} \sum_{j=v_{\text{top}}+1}^{k+1} \binom{k+1}{j}$. Under a per-probe cost and a hard budget the Bayes-optimal rule stops at the first k with this probability at or above a bound $\theta(t_k)$ that is non-increasing in the budget used [147].*

Values. One probe 0.75; two agreeing 0.875; $[2, 1]$ 0.6875; $[3, 1]$ 0.8125. With θ falling linearly from 0.85 to 0.70 the rule reproduces the "two consecutive agreeing probes" rule early in the budget, never stops on one probe, votes over all probes (Theorem 6) rather than the last two, and lets a $[3, 1]$ split stop once about 45 % of the budget is used (FR-084). Verifiable tasks are untouched: the exact verifier is the stopping signal (Theorem 1).

Proposition 17 (Optimal probe interval)**.** [exact under an exponential model] *If the reasoning length at which the answer becomes available is exponential with mean m tokens, a probe costs c_p seconds and decoding runs at v tokens per second, the periodic interval minimising probe cost plus overshoot is $\Delta^\star = \sqrt{2 c_p v m}$, with $\text{cost}(\Delta)/\text{cost}(\Delta^\star) = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta/\Delta^\star + \Delta^\star/\Delta)$.*

Measured. Idle: $c_p \approx 0.7\,\text{s}$, $v \approx 8$, $m \approx 300$ give $\Delta^\star \approx 58$ tokens; the configured gap of 64 costs 0.5 % more than the optimum (1 % under the shared load). The schedule is validated and unchanged (A-059). This is the quantitative content of the "quantum Zeno" intuition that measuring often is costly; here a probe has no back-action, only a price.

C. Measurements

All measurements were taken on the shared reference machine (load average 5–11, other sessions compiling); accuracy and log-probabilities do not depend on load, wall-clock figures do.

Confidence-signal study (ER-021). 150 GSM8K test items were drafted by System 1 under the production prompt and sampling (temperature 0.2, top-p 0.8, no thinking) and scored by the exact numeric verifier: 31 drafts are wrong (accuracy 0.793). Table XVI gives, for each candidate signal, the AUROC for predicting a wrong draft (lower signal flags the draft; 400-resample bootstrap interval) and the recall and precision when the least confident 10 % and 20 % of drafts are escalated.

Three facts follow. First, *the fixed rule is blind on mathematics*: at the production threshold (-0.175 at the default λ) the mean-log-prob rule escalates 0 of 150 drafts and catches 0 of 31 wrong ones, because mathematics drafts have a mean log-prob of about -0.03 whether right or wrong; on the unverified mathematics path every wrong draft was kept, and because

TABLE XVI
WHICH CONFIDENCE SIGNAL OF A SYSTEM 1 DRAFT PREDICTS A WRONG DRAFT (150 GSM8K DRAFTS, 31 WRONG)

Signal	AUROC [95 % CI]	recall / precision at 10 %	at 20 %
lowest token log-prob	**0.646** [0.539, 0.746]	0.23 / 0.47	0.35 / 0.37
mean top-1/top-2 margin	0.614 [0.493, 0.729]	0.23 / 0.47	0.39 / 0.40
lowest 16-token window of the margin	0.611 [0.510, 0.715]	0.06 / 0.13	0.26 / 0.27
lowest 16-token window log-prob [153]	0.581 [0.488, 0.698]	0.13 / 0.27	0.29 / 0.30
negative mean top-5 entropy	0.573 [0.453, 0.679]	0.16 / 0.33	0.24 / 0.25
mean log-prob (the fixed rule)	0.564 [0.449, 0.672]	0.13 / 0.27	0.26 / 0.27
bottom-10 % tokens	0.555 [0.459, 0.675]	0.10 / 0.20	0.23 / 0.23
tail (last 32 tokens)	0.492 [0.366, 0.631]	0.19 / 0.40	0.23 / 0.23

such drafts never enter the uncertainty band the agreement samples were never drawn either. Second, *token confidence is a weak metacognitive signal* for this model on this task: the best signal is the single lowest token, and the window signal's interval includes chance, so no ROC dominates (Proposition 13) and the signal that Proposition 14 makes exact to act on is not the one worth acting on. Third, *Theorem 2 forbids escalating on any of them at the default price*: escalation pays only if $\mathbb{P}[\text{wrong} \mid \text{escalated}] > \hat{e}_2 + \lambda\Delta c/(L \cdot \text{cost unit}) = 0.15 + 0.2 \cdot 150/60 = 0.65$, and the highest precision reached at an escalation rate of at least 10 % is 0.47. By Proposition 10 the expected accuracy of a gate escalating the 20 % least confident drafts by the lowest token is 0.847–0.867 (System 2 accuracy 0.9–1.0) against 0.793, for about 30 s of mean latency per question, which the default price rates as a loss. *Decision:* the window signal is recorded on every decision and read by the calibrated gate, but its fixed-rule threshold stays off (A-057): the mechanism is exact, the measured signal is not strong enough to use it. The repository keeps this negative result next to the positive ones.

Agreement with cheap samples. The gate's second signal, agreement between the draft and $k = 2$ cheap System 1 samples, was never computed on mathematics because the samples are drawn only inside the uncertainty band of the mean log-prob. For the first 60 drafts the samples were drawn exactly as production draws them and compared with the draft's final number (12 of 60 drafts wrong; 54 s per item on the loaded machine). Agreement has AUROC 0.759 [0.618, 0.901] and, with ties broken by the lowest token, 0.823 [0.690, 0.940], against 0.720 for the lowest token and 0.611 for the window on the same drafts. The rule "any disagreement" (the configured threshold at the default care) escalates 25 % of drafts, catches 8 of the 12 wrong ones (precision 0.53) and raises the expected cascade accuracy from 0.800 to 0.908–0.933. This is what Theorem 6 predicts: a wrong low-temperature draft is usually one whose answer holds no majority at temperature 0.8. *Decision (implemented, FR-085):* unverified mathematics drafts always get their two samples (`gate.samples_on_unverified_domains`), whatever their token confidence says (A-060). Its precision is still below the 0.65 bar of Theorem 2 at the default price, so the calibrated gate, once promoted, will price it rather than apply it unconditionally.

Exit rules on factual prompts (FR-084). A paired Lab run on six factual prompts (run `73cd5bba`, 512-token budget, shared machine) compared the consistency rule with the posterior rule. Both gave the same factual content on every prompt; reasoning tokens were 357 against 382 on average (wall 93 s against 101 s), two prompts exhausting the budget under both rules. Where they diverged most, the probes disagreed first and then agreed: the consistency rule stopped at the two consecutive agreeing probes (183 tokens) while the posterior rule saw $[2, 1]$ split below its bound and continued to $[3, 1]$ (318 tokens), as Proposition 16 prescribes. That caution costs tokens on this set, so by the criterion fixed in advance (A-058) the posterior rule stays an option and the consistency rule remains the default; the comparison is indicative ($n = 6$, no exact labels).

D. What changed

The crate `nafs-core` gains a `sequential` module (the window signal and its streaming tracker, the probe posterior with the exact beta tail, the collapsing bound, Wald's bound and the probe interval, each with tests of the property its proposition states). Every gate decision now records `low_window_logprob`; the calibrated gate reads it as an eighth feature; the fixed rule applies it for the measured domains and stops the draft at the crossing; the adaptive exit offers the posterior rule per request and in the Lab (`slow_exit_posterior` against `slow_exit_consistency`). Nothing was added for the quantum-consciousness ideas; Propositions 11–12 are the record of why.

XI. LIMITATIONS AND ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

Indicative results. Section IX reports measurements on one shared four-core machine with tens of items per comparison, far below the sample sizes of Section VIII; the quality claims remain hypotheses until the release-scale runs. The formal results hold under their stated assumptions, several of which (conditional independence of verifiers, a Beta prior on acceptance, homogeneous refinement dynamics, concave budget returns) are modelling choices to be checked.

Shared weights. Fast and slow paths from one model family make correlated errors; the collision term is measured rather than assumed small, and the judge shares the same bias, which is why exact verifiers carry the safety case.

CPU constraint. On the reference machine the slow path takes minutes; the design is honest about this and makes interactive deliberation a GPU-profile feature. Published AVX2 throughput data are sparse; our own measurements cover two models and one machine.

Verifiers are partial. Only code, mathematics and structured output have exact verifiers; everything else is at best a consensus or judge assurance, which Theorem 6 shows has a floor. Test-based code verification can be gamed by overfitting to visible tests; hidden tests and mutation testing are required.

Security. The system executes model-written code in a sandbox and consumes untrusted text; prompt injection through retrieved memory or tool output is a first-class threat [121],

[154]. The specification isolates the sandbox, strips instructions from retrieved content, and never lets observed content change controller parameters.

Religious content. The classical vocabulary is used as analogy and the components have plain names in code. We do not claim that the software has a soul, consciousness or moral standing; we do not model the *ruh*; and we cite scripture and hadith by number from named translations. The analogy section should be reviewed by scholars of the tradition, and users of the chat system who ask religious questions receive answers with the same assurance labelling as any other non-verifiable domain, with no claim of authority.

Data and privacy. Conversation traces feed the self-model and the distillation set; the specification requires consent, retention limits, redaction of personal data before training, and exclusion of any conversation from training on request.

Hallucination and faithfulness. Separating reasoning content from the answer does not make the reasoning faithful [119], [155]; we treat the trace as evidence for debugging and distillation, not as an explanation to the user.

XII. Conclusion

Nafs-Aql is a buildable dual-process system: a small Qwen model answers fast, a calibrated gate decides when deliberation pays, a second model (or the same model in thinking mode) deliberates under a budget, exact verifiers decide what counts as known, and an audited ledger keeps the system honest about itself. The classical account of the self supplied the vocabulary and, more usefully, three disciplines that translate directly into engineering: the intellect arbitrates on cost and risk, the self is corrected under an external standard, and dispositions change slowly through verified practice. The mathematics turned those disciplines into a threshold gate, a verifier-bounded precision, a stable loop and a sized set of release gates. The feasibility study showed what October 2026 permits on a four-core machine: Qwen3 and Qwen3.5 below 9B parameters, llama-server or vLLM-CPU behind one API, Unsloth on a rented GPU, and a Rust gateway. The specification and roadmap that accompany this report give the team requirements with identifiers, machine-readable interfaces, and a phased plan with measurable gates. The first three actions are to run the Phase-0 baseline at the required sample size, to measure the verifiers' false-accept rates by mutation testing, and to benchmark the Qwen3.5 hybrid models against dense Qwen3 on the target CPU before choosing the upgrade path. The second and third are done and the first runs only at a scaled-down size on one CPU. With the system built, the cascade runs end to end on a shared four-core CPU, the verifiers are measured, Profile C was evaluated and not adopted, and latency is attributed by stage, which points the next work at decode speed (EAGLE-3 and repacked weights) and at release-scale evaluation on a faster host.

References

[1] J. Wei, X. Wang, D. Schuurmans, M. Bosma, B. Ichter, F. Xia, E. Chi, Q. Le, and D. Zhou, "Chain-of-thought prompting elicits reasoning in large language models," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 35, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2201.11903

[2] X. Wang, J. Wei, D. Schuurmans, Q. Le, E. Chi, S. Narang, A. Chowdhery, and D. Zhou, "Self-consistency improves chain of thought reasoning in language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2203.11171

[3] C. Snell, J. Lee, K. Xu, and A. Kumar, "Scaling LLM test-time compute optimally can be more effective than scaling parameters for reasoning," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025, arXiv preprint (Aug. 2024) titled "Scaling LLM Test-Time Compute Optimally can be More Effective than Scaling Model Parameters". [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2408.03314

[4] DeepSeek-AI, D. Guo, D. Yang, H. Zhang, J. Song, P. Wang, Q. Zhu, R. Xu, R. Zhang, S. Ma, X. Bi *et al.*, "DeepSeek-R1: Incentivizing reasoning capability in LLMs via reinforcement learning," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.12948*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2501.12948

[5] X. Chen, J. Xu, T. Liang, Z. He, J. Pang, D. Yu, L. Song, Q. Liu, M. Zhou, Z. Zhang, R. Wang, Z. Tu, H. Mi, and D. Yu, "Do NOT think that much for 2+3=? On the overthinking of o1-like LLMs," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.21187*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.21187

[6] J. Zhang, N. Lin, L. Hou, L. Feng, and J. Li, "AdaptThink: Reasoning models can learn when to think," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.13417*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.13417

[7] D. Kahneman, *Thinking, Fast and Slow*. New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux, 2011.

[8] J. S. B. T. Evans and K. E. Stanovich, "Dual-process theories of higher cognition: Advancing the debate," *Perspectives on Psychological Science*, vol. 8, no. 3, pp. 223–241, 2013.

[9] S. A. Sloman, "The empirical case for two systems of reasoning," *Psychological Bulletin*, vol. 119, no. 1, pp. 3–22, 1996.

[10] Abdel Haleem, M. A. S. (trans.), *The Qur'an*, ser. Oxford World's Classics. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2008, paperback reissue of the Oxford World's Classics translation. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780199535958

[11] A. Ḥ. al Ghazālī, *Al-Ghazali: The Marvels of the Heart. Science of the Spirit. Book 21 of the Revival of the Religious Sciences (Iḥyā' 'Ulūm al-Dīn)*. Louisville, KY: Fons Vitae, 2010, translated by Walter James Skellie; introduction by T. J. Winter. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://www.fonsvitae.com/product/al-ghazali-the-marvels-of-the-heart/

[12] G. Picken, *Spiritual Purification in Islam: The Life and Works of al-Muhasibi*, ser. Routledge Sufi Series. London and New York: Routledge, 2011, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://www.routledge.com/Spiritual-Purification-in-Islam-The-Life-and-Works-of-al-Muhasibi/Picken/p/book/9780415548229

[13] A. l.-Q. A. a.-K. al Qushayrī, *Al-Qushayri's Epistle on Sufism: Al-Risāla al-qushayriyya fī 'ilm al-taṣawwuf*, ser. Great Books of Islamic Civilization. Reading: Garnet Publishing, 2007, translated by Alexander D. Knysh. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9781859641866

[14] Dirac R&D Team, "Nafs-aql v0.1: Mathematical validation and technical report of a dual-process agent on Qwen (internal draft slide deck)," Oct. 2026, internal document, `nafs_aql_report.tex`, 18 October 2026.

[15] E. E. Calverley and I. R. Netton, "Nafs," in *Encyclopaedia of Islam, Second Edition*, P. Bearman, T. Bianquis, C. E. Bosworth, E. van Donzel, and W. P. Heinrichs, Eds. Leiden: Brill, 2012, first published online 2012; print edition 1960–2007. Title, container and DOI confirmed on the Crossref DOI record; Brill's pages returned 403 to direct access, so the author line was read from Brill's own citation string as surfaced by web search – confirm with library access before final submission. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1163/1573-3912_islam_COM_0833

[16] A. Schimmel, *Mystical Dimensions of Islam*. Chapel Hill, NC: University of North Carolina Press, 1975, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780807812716

[17] A. Rothman and A. Coyle, "Toward a framework for islamic psychology and psychotherapy: An islamic model of the soul," *Journal of Religion and Health*, vol. 57, no. 5, pp. 1731–1744, 2018, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6132620/

[18] A. Ḥ. al Ghazālī, *Al-Ghazālī on Disciplining the Soul (Kitāb Riyāḍat al-nafs) and on Breaking the Two Desires (Kitāb Kasr al-shahwatayn): Books XXII and XXIII of the Revival of the Religious*

Sciences (Iḥyā' 'Ulūm al-Dīn). Cambridge: Islamic Texts Society, 1995, translated with an introduction and notes by T. J. Winter. First edition 1995 (confirmed via the 1997 AJISS review essay, DOI 10.35632/ajis.v14i4.2218); ITS catalogue lists the 2016 reprint. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://its.org.uk/

[19] F. Griffel, *Al-Ghazālī's Philosophical Theology*. Oxford and New York: Oxford University Press, 2009, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780195331622

[20] ——, "al-ghazali," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta and U. Nodelman, Eds. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2026, first published 14 August 2007; substantive revision 15 January 2026. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/al-ghazali/

[21] T. Kukkonen, "Receptive to reality: Al-ghazālī on the structure of the soul," *The Muslim World*, vol. 102, no. 3–4, pp. 541–561, 2012, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1478-1913.2012.01412.x

[22] ——, "Al-ghazālī on error," in *Islam and Rationality: The Impact of al-Ghazālī. Papers Collected on His 900th Anniversary*, F. Griffel, Ed. Leiden: Brill, 2016, vol. 2, pp. 3–31, editor and volume number from the Crossref container record; verify against the printed volume. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1163/9789004307490_002

[23] Ibn Sīnā (Avicenna), *Avicenna's Psychology: An English Translation of Kitāb al-Najāt, Book II, Chapter VI, with Historico-Philosophical Notes and Textual Improvements on the Cairo Edition*. London: Oxford University Press, 1952, translation by F. Rahman. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://catalogue.bnf.fr/ark:/12148/cb31745014f

[24] ——, *Avicenna's De Anima (Arabic Text): Being the Psychological Part of Kitāb al-Shifā'*, F. Rahman, Ed. London and New York: Oxford University Press, 1959, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://wellcomecollection.org/works/g9jzxtmj

[25] J. McGinnis, *Avicenna*, ser. Great Medieval Thinkers. Oxford and New York: Oxford University Press, 2010, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780195331479

[26] D. Gutas, "Ibn sina [avicenna]," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta and U. Nodelman, Eds. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2025, first published 15 September 2016; substantive revision 31 October 2025. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ibn-sina/

[27] A. Ivry, "Arabic and islamic psychology and philosophy of mind," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta, Ed. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2012, summer 2012 Edition; first published 18 April 2008, substantive revision 29 May 2012. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/arabic-islamic-mind/

[28] D. L. Black, "Estimation (wahm) in avicenna: The logical and psychological dimensions," *Dialogue: Canadian Philosophical Review*, vol. 32, no. 2, pp. 219–258, 1993, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1017/S0012217300014414

[29] D. Gutas, *Avicenna and the Aristotelian Tradition: Introduction to Reading Avicenna's Philosophical Works*, 2nd ed., ser. Islamic Philosophy, Theology and Science. Texts and Studies. Leiden: Brill, 2014, vol. 89, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9789004255807

[30] S. Rizvi, "Mulla sadra," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta, Ed. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2019, first published 9 June 2009; substantive revision 5 February 2019 (Spring 2021 archive edition). Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/mulla-sadra/

[31] M. E. Marmura, "Avicenna's "flying man" in context," *The Monist*, vol. 69, no. 3, pp. 383–395, 1986, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.5840/monist198669328

[32] J. Kaukua, *Self-Awareness in Islamic Philosophy: Avicenna and Beyond*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2015, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9781316105238

[33] W. C. Chittick, *The Sufi Path of Knowledge: Ibn al-'Arabi's Metaphysics of Imagination*. Albany, NY: State University of New York Press, 1989, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://sunypress.edu/Books/T/The-Sufi-Path-of-Knowledge2

[34] ——, "Ibn 'arabī," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta and U. Nodelman, Eds. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2025, first published 5 August 2008; substantive revision 5 December 2025. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ibn-arabi/

[35] R. Marcotte, "Suhrawardi," in *The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, E. N. Zalta and U. Nodelman, Eds. Metaphysics Research Lab, Stanford University, 2019, first published 26 December 2007; substantive revision 29 March 2019 (Spring 2025 archive edition). Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/suhrawardi/

[36] M. Ha'iri Yazdi, *The Principles of Epistemology in Islamic Philosophy: Knowledge by Presence*. Albany, NY: State University of New York Press, 1992, foreword by Seyyed Hossein Nasr. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://sunypress.edu/Books/T/The-Principles-of-Epistemology-in-Islamic-Philosophy

[37] S. H. Rizvi, *Mulla Sadra and Metaphysics: Modulation of Being*, ser. Culture and Civilization in the Middle East. London and New York: Routledge, 2009, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://www.routledge.com/Mulla-Sadra-and-Metaphysics-Modulation-of-Being/Rizvi/p/book/9780415490733

[38] I. Kalin, *Knowledge in Later Islamic Philosophy: Mullā Ṣadrā on Existence, Intellect, and Intuition*. Oxford and New York: Oxford University Press, 2010, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780199735242

[39] F. Rahman, *The Philosophy of Mullā Ṣadrā (Ṣadr al-Dīn al-Shīrāzī)*. Albany, NY: State University of New York Press, 1975, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9780873953009

[40] T. J. Gianotti, *Al-Ghazālī's Unspeakable Doctrine of the Soul: Unveiling the Esoteric Psychology and Eschatology of the Iḥyā'*, ser. Brill's Studies in Intellectual History. Leiden: Brill, 2001, vol. 104, accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://books.google.co.id/books?vid=ISBN9004120831

[41] A. Treiger, *Inspired Knowledge in Islamic Thought: Al-Ghazālī's Theory of Mystical Cognition and Its Avicennian Foundation*. London and New York: Routledge, 2011, crossref gives 2011 (e-book); Griffel's SEP bibliography cites it as 2012. Accessed 2026-10-18. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203806487

[42] K. E. Stanovich and R. F. West, "Individual differences in reasoning: Implications for the rationality debate?" *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, vol. 23, no. 5, pp. 645–665, 2000.

[43] A. Shenhav, M. M. Botvinick, and J. D. Cohen, "The expected value of control: An integrative theory of anterior cingulate cortex function," *Neuron*, vol. 79, no. 2, pp. 217–240, 2013.

[44] F. Lieder and T. L. Griffiths, "Resource-rational analysis: Understanding human cognition as the optimal use of limited computational resources," *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, vol. 43, p. e1, 2020.

[45] S. Russell and E. Wefald, "Principles of metareasoning," *Artificial Intelligence*, vol. 49, no. 1-3, pp. 361–395, 1991.

[46] B. Brown, J. Juravsky, R. Ehrlich, R. Clark, Q. V. Le, C. Ré, and A. Mirhoseini, "Large language monkeys: Scaling inference compute with repeated sampling," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2407.21787*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.21787

[47] K. Cobbe, V. Kosaraju, M. Bavarian, M. Chen, H. Jun, L. Kaiser, M. Plappert, J. Tworek, J. Hilton, R. Nakano, C. Hesse, and J. Schulman, "Training verifiers to solve math word problems," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2110.14168*, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2110.14168

[48] H. Lightman, V. Kosaraju, Y. Burda, H. Edwards, B. Baker, T. Lee, J. Leike, J. Schulman, I. Sutskever, and K. Cobbe, "Let's verify step by step," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.20050

[49] D. Guo, D. Yang, H. Zhang, J. Song, P. Wang, Q. Zhu, R. Xu, R. Zhang, S. Ma, X. Bi *et al.*, "DeepSeek-R1 incentivizes reasoning in LLMs through reinforcement learning," *Nature*, vol. 645, pp. 633–638, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-025-09422-z

[50] OpenAI, A. Jaech, A. Kalai, A. Lerer, A. Richardson, A. El-Kishky *et al.*, "OpenAI o1 system card," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.16720*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.16720

[51] N. Muennighoff, Z. Yang, W. Shi, X. L. Li, L. Fei-Fei, H. Hajishirzi, L. Zettlemoyer, P. Liang, E. Candès, and T. Hashimoto, "s1: Simple test-time scaling," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.19393*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2501.19393

[52] A. Yang, A. Li, B. Yang *et al.*, "Qwen3 technical report," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.09388*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.09388

[53] A. Madaan, N. Tandon, P. Gupta, S. Hallinan, L. Gao, S. Wiegreffe, U. Alon, N. Dziri, S. Prabhumoye, Y. Yang, S. Gupta, B. P. Majumder, K. Hermann, S. Welleck, A. Yazdanbakhsh, and P. Clark, "Self-refine: Iterative refinement with self-feedback," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 36, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2303.17651

[54] N. Shinn, F. Cassano, A. Gopinath, K. Narasimhan, and S. Yao, "Reflexion: Language agents with verbal reinforcement learning," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 36, 2023, arXiv version (2303.11366) additionally lists Edward Berman as an author. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2303.11366

[55] J. Huang, X. Chen, S. Mishra, H. S. Zheng, A. W. Yu, X. Song, and D. Zhou, "Large language models cannot self-correct reasoning yet," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.01798

[56] R. Kamoi, Y. Zhang, N. Zhang, J. Han, and R. Zhang, "When can LLMs actually correct their own mistakes? A critical survey of self-correction of LLMs," *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, vol. 12, pp. 1417–1440, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2406.01297

[57] G. Fang, X. Ma, and X. Wang, "Thinkless: LLM learns when to think," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.13379*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.13379

[58] Y. He, X. Ding, B. Cai, Y. Zhang, K. Xiong, Z. Sun, B. Qin, and T. Liu, "Self-route: Automatic mode switching via capability estimation for efficient reasoning," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.20664*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.20664

[59] B. Hou, Y. Zhang, J. Ji, Y. Liu, K. Qian, J. Andreas, and S. Chang, "ThinkPrune: Pruning long chain-of-thought of LLMs via reinforcement learning," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.01296*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.01296

[60] C. Yang, Q. Si, Y. Duan, Z. Zhu, C. Zhu, Q. Li, M. Chen, Z. Lin, and W. Wang, "Dynamic early exit in reasoning models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.15895*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.15895

[61] D. Arora and A. Zanette, "Training language models to reason efficiently," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2502.04463

[62] J. Lin, X. Zeng, J. Zhu, S. Wang, J. Shun, J. Wu, and D. Zhou, "Plan and budget: Effective and efficient test-time scaling on reasoning large language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.16122

[63] Z. Zhai, B. Li, B. Xiao, M. Li, and X. Wang, "Adaptive test-time compute allocation for reasoning LLMs via constrained policy optimization," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.14853*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.14853

[64] C. Fan, Y. Cheng, M. Li, Y. Liang, T. Zhou, and S. Feizi, "Thinking hard, not smart: Reasoning models fail to ration test-time compute across questions," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.07968*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.07968

[65] Z. Zhou, L. Zhang, J. Wang, M. Yuan, S. Liu, T. Li, Y. Hu, and Y. Zhao, "Nice fold or hero call: Learning budget-efficient thinking under policy-dependent solvability," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.11625*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.11625

[66] Z. Xu, H. Xie, Z. Miao, W. Gong, C. Qian, and L. Li, "Stable adaptive thinking via advantage shaping and length-aware gradient regulation," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.22556*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.22556

[67] H. Guo, T. Wei, D. Wang, Y. Du, Z. Wang, J. Zhang, and Z. Sun, "Think when needed: Model-aware reasoning routing for LLM-based ranking," in *Proceedings of the 49th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR)*, 2026, venue per arXiv comment "Accepted by SIGIR2026". [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.18146

[68] D. Su, S. Sukhbaatar, M. Rabbat, Y. Tian, and Q. Zheng, "Dualformer: Controllable fast and slow thinking by learning with randomized reasoning traces," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.09918

[69] S. Saha, A. Prasad, J. C.-Y. Chen, P. Hase, E. Stengel-Eskin, and M. Bansal, "System-1.x: Learning to balance fast and slow planning with language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.14414

[70] G. Booch, F. Fabiano, L. Horesh, K. Kate, J. Lenchner, N. Linck, A. Loreggia, K. Murugesan, N. Mattei, F. Rossi, and B. Srivastava, "Thinking fast and slow in AI," in *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, vol. 35, no. 17, 2021, pp. 15 042–15 046. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2010.06002

[71] Y. Bengio, "From System 1 deep learning to System 2 deep learning," Invited talk (Posner Lecture), Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2019. [Online]. Available: https://neurips.cc/virtual/2019/invited-talk/15488

[72] D. Ding, A. Mallick, C. Wang, R. Sim, S. Mukherjee, V. Ruhle, L. V. S. Lakshmanan, and A. H. Awadallah, "Hybrid LLM: Cost-efficient and quality-aware query routing," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.14618

[73] I. Ong, A. Almahairi, V. Wu, W.-L. Chiang, T. Wu, J. E. Gonzalez, M. W. Kadous, and I. Stoica, "RouteLLM: Learning to route LLMs from preference data," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025, arXiv version titled "RouteLLM: Learning to Route LLMs with Preference Data". [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2406.18665

[74] M. Yue, J. Zhao, M. Zhang, L. Du, and Z. Yao, "Large language model cascades with mixture of thoughts representations for cost-efficient reasoning," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.03094

[75] L. Chen, M. Zaharia, and J. Zou, "FrugalGPT: How to use large language models while reducing cost and improving performance," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2305.05176*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.05176

[76] C. K. Chow, "On optimum recognition error and reject tradeoff," *IEEE Transactions on Information Theory*, vol. 16, no. 1, pp. 41–46, 1970.

[77] Y. Geifman and R. El-Yaniv, "Selective classification for deep neural networks," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS)*, vol. 30, 2017. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1705.08500

[78] D. Madras, T. Pitassi, and R. Zemel, "Predict responsibly: Improving fairness and accuracy by learning to defer," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 31, 2018. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1711.06664

[79] H. Mozannar and D. Sontag, "Consistent estimators for learning to defer to an expert," in *Proceedings of the 37th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2020. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2006.01862

[80] C. Guo, G. Pleiss, Y. Sun, and K. Q. Weinberger, "On calibration of modern neural networks," in *Proceedings of the 34th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2017. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.04599

[81] S. Kadavath, T. Conerly, A. Askell, T. Henighan, D. Drain, E. Perez *et al.*, "Language models (mostly) know what they know," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2207.05221*, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2207.05221

[82] K. Tian, E. Mitchell, A. Zhou, A. Sharma, R. Rafailov, H. Yao, C. Finn, and C. D. Manning, "Just ask for calibration: Strategies for eliciting calibrated confidence scores from language models fine-tuned with human feedback," in *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.14975

[83] A. N. Angelopoulos and S. Bates, "Conformal prediction: A gentle introduction," *Foundations and Trends in Machine Learning*, vol. 16, no. 4, pp. 494–591, 2023, arXiv version (2107.07511, 2021) titled "A Gentle Introduction to Conformal Prediction and Distribution-Free Uncertainty Quantification". [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2107.07511

[84] Y. Leviathan, M. Kalman, and Y. Matias, "Fast inference from transformers via speculative decoding," in *Proceedings of the 40th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2211.17192

[85] C. Chen, S. Borgeaud, G. Irving, J.-B. Lespiau, L. Sifre, and J. Jumper, "Accelerating large language model decoding with speculative sampling," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2302.01318*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2302.01318

[86] T. Cai, Y. Li, Z. Geng, H. Peng, J. D. Lee, D. Chen, and T. Dao, "Medusa: Simple LLM inference acceleration framework with multiple decoding heads," in *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, ser. PMLR, vol. 235, 2024, pp. 5209–5235. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2401.10774

[87] Y. Li, F. Wei, C. Zhang, and H. Zhang, "EAGLE: Speculative sampling requires rethinking feature uncertainty," in *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, ser. PMLR, vol. 235, 2024, pp. 28 935–28 948. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2401.15077

[88] F. Gloeckle, B. Y. Idrissi, B. Rozière, D. Lopez-Paz, and G. Synnaeve, "Better & faster large language models via multi-token prediction," in *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine*

Learning (ICML), ser. PMLR, vol. 235, 2024, pp. 15 706–15 734. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.19737

[89] A. Graves, "Adaptive computation time for recurrent neural networks," *arXiv preprint arXiv:1603.08983*, 2016. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1603.08983

[90] D. Raposo, S. Ritter, B. Richards, T. Lillicrap, P. C. Humphreys, and A. Santoro, "Mixture-of-depths: Dynamically allocating compute in transformer-based language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2404.02258*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.02258

[91] J. Gu, J. Bradbury, C. Xiong, V. O. K. Li, and R. Socher, "Non-autoregressive neural machine translation," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2018. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1711.02281

[92] M. Ghazvininejad, O. Levy, Y. Liu, and L. Zettlemoyer, "Mask-predict: Parallel decoding of conditional masked language models," in *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2019. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1904.09324

[93] J. Austin, D. D. Johnson, J. Ho, D. Tarlow, and R. van den Berg, "Structured denoising diffusion models in discrete state-spaces," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 34, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2107.03006

[94] A. Lou, C. Meng, and S. Ermon, "Discrete diffusion modeling by estimating the ratios of the data distribution," in *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.16834

[95] S. S. Sahoo, M. Arriola, Y. Schiff, A. Gokaslan, E. Marroquin, J. T. Chiu, A. Rush, and V. Kuleshov, "Simple and effective masked diffusion language models," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2406.07524

[96] S. Nie, F. Zhu, Z. You, X. Zhang, J. Ou, J. Hu, J. Zhou, Y. Lin, J.-R. Wen, and C. Li, "Large language diffusion models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2502.09992*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2502.09992

[97] J. Ye, Z. Xie, L. Zheng, J. Gao, Z. Wu, X. Jiang, Z. Li, and L. Kong, "Dream 7b: Diffusion large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.15487*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.15487

[98] S. Gong, R. Zhang, H. Zheng, J. Gu, N. Jaitly, L. Kong, and Y. Zhang, "DiffuCoder: Understanding and improving masked diffusion models for code generation," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.20639*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.20639

[99] M. Arriola, A. Gokaslan, J. T. Chiu, Z. Yang, Z. Qi, J. Han, S. S. Sahoo, and V. Kuleshov, "Block diffusion: Interpolating between autoregressive and diffusion language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.09573

[100] S. Cheng, Y. Bian, D. Liu, Y. Jiang, Y. Liu, L. Zhang, Q. Yao, Z. Tian, W. Wang, Q. Guo, K. Chen, B. Qi, and B. Zhou, "SDAR: A synergistic diffusion-autoregression paradigm for scalable sequence generation," in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*, 2026, pp. 22 058–22 075, arXiv version (2510.06303, Oct. 2025) lists 11 authors. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.06303

[101] Y. Wang, L. Yang, B. Li, Y. Tian, K. Shen, and M. Wang, "Revolutionizing reinforcement learning framework for diffusion large language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026, introduces TraceRL and the TraDo model family. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.06949

[102] C. Wu, H. Zhang, S. Xue, S. Diao, Y. Fu, Z. Liu, P. Molchanov, P. Luo, S. Han, and E. Xie, "Fast-dLLM v2: Efficient block-diffusion LLM," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.26328

[103] C. Wu, H. Zhang, S. Xue, Z. Liu, S. Diao, L. Zhu, P. Luo, S. Han, and E. Xie, "Fast-dLLM: Training-free acceleration of diffusion LLM by enabling KV cache and parallel decoding," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.22618*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.22618

[104] Inception Labs, S. Khanna, S. Kharbanda, S. Li, H. Varma, E. Wang, S. Birnbaum, Z. Luo, Y. Miraoui, A. Palrecha, S. Ermon, A. Grover, and V. Kuleshov, "Mercury: Ultra-fast language models based on diffusion," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.17298*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17298

[105] T. Li, M. Chen, B. Guo, and Z. Shen, "A survey on diffusion language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.10875*, 2025, v3 revised June 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.10875

[106] A. Santilli, S. Severino, E. Postolache, V. Maiorca, M. Mancusi, R. Marin, and E. Rodolà, "Accelerating transformer inference for translation via parallel decoding," in *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.10427

[107] S. Kou, L. Hu, Z. He, Z. Deng, and H. Zhang, "CLLMs: Consistency large language models," in *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2403.00835

[108] Qwen Team, "Qwen3.5: Towards native multimodal agents," https://qwen.ai/blog?id=qwen3.5, Feb. 2026, no standalone technical report as of 2026-10-18; model cards cite this post.

[109] ——, "Qwen3.6-27b: Flagship-level coding in a 27b dense model," https://qwen.ai/blog?id=qwen3.6-27b, Apr. 2026.

[110] ——, "Qwen3.6-35b-a3b: Agentic coding power, now open to all," https://qwen.ai/blog?id=qwen3.6-35b-a3b, Apr. 2026.

[111] ——, "Qwen3.8-max: A new bar for coding and cowork," https://qwen.ai/blog?id=qwen3.8, Aug. 2026, cited by the Qwen3.8-27B model card; no technical report.

[112] Y. S. Chow, H. Robbins, and D. Siegmund, *Great Expectations: The Theory of Optimal Stopping*. Boston, MA, USA: Houghton Mifflin, 1971, reissued by Dover, 1991, as *The Theory of Optimal Stopping*. Verified via HathiTrust record 000469250, accessed 2026-10-18.

[113] W. Hoeffding, "Probability inequalities for sums of bounded random variables," *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, vol. 58, no. 301, pp. 13–30, 1963.

[114] C. J. Clopper and E. S. Pearson, "The use of confidence or fiducial limits illustrated in the case of the binomial," *Biometrika*, vol. 26, no. 4, pp. 404–413, 1934.

[115] P. Massart, "The tight constant in the Dvoretzky-Kiefer-Wolfowitz inequality," *The Annals of Probability*, vol. 18, no. 3, pp. 1269–1283, 1990.

[116] W. Kwon, Z. Li, S. Zhuang, Y. Sheng, L. Zheng, C. H. Yu, J. E. Gonzalez, H. Zhang, and I. Stoica, "Efficient memory management for large language model serving with PagedAttention," in *Proceedings of the 29th ACM Symposium on Operating Systems Principles (SOSP)*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2309.06180

[117] T. Dettmers, A. Pagnoni, A. Holtzman, and L. Zettlemoyer, "QLoRA: Efficient finetuning of quantized LLMs," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 36, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.14314

[118] E. J. Hu, Y. Shen, P. Wallis, Z. Allen-Zhu, Y. Li, S. Wang, L. Wang, and W. Chen, "LoRA: Low-rank adaptation of large language models," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2106.09685

[119] M. Turpin, J. Michael, E. Perez, and S. R. Bowman, "Language models don't always say what they think: Unfaithful explanations in chain-of-thought prompting," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 36, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.04388

[120] T. Lanham, A. Chen, A. Radhakrishnan, B. Steiner, C. Denison, D. Hernandez *et al.*, "Measuring faithfulness in chain-of-thought reasoning," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2307.13702*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.13702

[121] K. Greshake, S. Abdelnabi, S. Mishra, C. Endres, T. Holz, and M. Fritz, "Not what you've signed up for: Compromising real-world LLM-integrated applications with indirect prompt injection," in *Proceedings of the 16th ACM Workshop on Artificial Intelligence and Security (AISec)*, 2023, pp. 79–90. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2302.12173

[122] A. Zou, Z. Wang, N. Carlini, M. Nasr, J. Z. Kolter, and M. Fredrikson, "Universal and transferable adversarial attacks on aligned language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2307.15043*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.15043

[123] A. Wei, N. Haghtalab, and J. Steinhardt, "Jailbroken: How does LLM safety training fail?" in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 36, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.02483

[124] D. Hendrycks, C. Burns, S. Kadavath, A. Arora, S. Basart, E. Tang, D. Song, and J. Steinhardt, "Measuring mathematical problem solving with the MATH dataset," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), Datasets and Benchmarks Track*, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2103.03874

[125] M. Chen, J. Tworek, H. Jun, Q. Yuan, H. P. d. O. Pinto, J. Kaplan *et al.*, "Evaluating large language models trained on code," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2107.03374*, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2107.03374

[126] J. Austin, A. Odena, M. Nye, M. Bosma, H. Michalewski, D. Dohan, E. Jiang, C. Cai, M. Terry, Q. Le, and C. Sutton, "Program synthesis with large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2108.07732*, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2108.07732

[127] D. Hendrycks, C. Burns, S. Basart, A. Zou, M. Mazeika, D. Song, and J. Steinhardt, "Measuring massive multitask language understanding," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2021. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2009.03300

[128] D. Rein, B. L. Hou, A. C. Stickland, J. Petty, R. Y. Pang, J. Dirani, J. Michael, and S. R. Bowman, "GPQA: A graduate-level Google-proof Q&A benchmark," in *First Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2311.12022

[129] S. Lin, J. Hilton, and O. Evans, "TruthfulQA: Measuring how models mimic human falsehoods," in *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2109.07958

[130] J. Wei, N. Karina, H. W. Chung, Y. J. Jiao, S. Papay, A. Glaese, J. Schulman, and W. Fedus, "Measuring short-form factuality in large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2411.04368*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.04368

[131] M. Suzgun, N. Scales, N. Schärli, S. Gehrmann, Y. Tay, H. W. Chung, A. Chowdhery, Q. V. Le, E. H. Chi, D. Zhou, and J. Wei, "Challenging BIG-Bench tasks and whether chain-of-thought can solve them," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2210.09261*, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2210.09261

[132] N. Jain, K. Han, A. Gu, W.-D. Li, F. Yan, T. Zhang, S. Wang, A. Solar-Lezama, K. Sen, and I. Stoica, "LiveCodeBench: Holistic and contamination free evaluation of large language models for code," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2403.07974

[133] L. Zheng, W.-L. Chiang, Y. Sheng, S. Zhuang, Z. Wu, Y. Zhuang, Z. Lin, Z. Li, D. Li, E. P. Xing, H. Zhang, J. E. Gonzalez, and I. Stoica, "Judging LLM-as-a-judge with MT-Bench and Chatbot Arena," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), Datasets and Benchmarks Track*, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2306.05685

[134] E. S. Page, "Continuous inspection schemes," *Biometrika*, vol. 41, no. 1-2, pp. 100–115, 1954.

[135] S. Hameroff and R. Penrose, "Consciousness in the universe: A review of the 'Orch OR' theory," *Physics of Life Reviews*, vol. 11, no. 1, pp. 39–78, 2014. [Online]. Available: https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24070914/

[136] M. Tegmark, "Importance of quantum decoherence in brain processes," *Physical Review E*, vol. 61, no. 4, pp. 4194–4206, 2000. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/quant-ph/9907009

[137] S. Hagan, S. R. Hameroff, and J. A. Tuszyński, "Quantum computation in brain microtubules: Decoherence and biological feasibility," *Physical Review E*, vol. 65, p. 061901, 2002.

[138] N. S. Babcock, G. Montes-Cabrera, K. E. Oberhofer, M. Chergui, G. L. Celardo, and P. Kurian, "Ultraviolet superradiance from mega-networks of tryptophan in biological architectures," *The Journal of Physical Chemistry B*, vol. 128, no. 17, pp. 4035–4046, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11075083/

[139] J. R. Busemeyer and P. D. Bruza, *Quantum Models of Cognition and Decision*. Cambridge University Press, 2012.

[140] E. M. Pothos and J. R. Busemeyer, "Can quantum probability provide a new direction for cognitive modeling?" *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, vol. 36, no. 3, pp. 255–274, 2013.

[141] Z. Wang and J. R. Busemeyer, "A quantum question order model supported by empirical tests of an a priori and precise prediction," *Topics in Cognitive Science*, vol. 5, no. 4, pp. 689–710, 2013.

[142] Z. Wang, T. Solloway, R. M. Shiffrin, and J. R. Busemeyer, "Context effects produced by question orders reveal quantum nature of human judgments," *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, vol. 111, no. 26, pp. 9431–9436, 2014.

[143] "Auditing question-order effects in large language models with the QQ equality: Mechanism characterization and a saturation caveat," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.17219*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2607.17219

[144] J. I. Gold and M. N. Shadlen, "The neural basis of decision making," *Annual Review of Neuroscience*, vol. 30, pp. 535–574, 2007.

[145] A. Wald, "Sequential tests of statistical hypotheses," *The Annals of Mathematical Statistics*, vol. 16, no. 2, pp. 117–186, 1945.

[146] A. Wald and J. Wolfowitz, "Optimum character of the sequential probability ratio test," *The Annals of Mathematical Statistics*, vol. 19, no. 3, pp. 326–339, 1948. [Online]. Available: https://www.projecteuclid.org/euclid.aoms/1177730197

[147] P. I. Frazier and A. J. Yu, "Sequential hypothesis testing under stochastic deadlines," in *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 20 (NIPS 2007)*, 2007, pp. 465–472. [Online]. Available: https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper/2007/hash/9c82c7143c102b71c593d98d96093fde-Abstract.html

[148] J. Drugowitsch, R. Moreno-Bote, A. K. Churchland, M. N. Shadlen, and A. Pouget, "The cost of accumulating evidence in perceptual decision making," *Journal of Neuroscience*, vol. 32, no. 11, pp. 3612–3628, 2012.

[149] S. M. Fleming and H. C. Lau, "How to measure metacognition," *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, vol. 8, p. 443, 2014. [Online]. Available: https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fnhum.2014.00443

[150] S. Dehaene and J.-P. Changeux, "Experimental and theoretical approaches to conscious processing," *Neuron*, vol. 70, no. 2, pp. 200–227, 2011.

[151] P. Aggarwal, A. Madaan, Y. Yang, and Mausam, "Let's sample step by step: Adaptive-consistency for efficient reasoning and coding with LLMs," in *Proceedings of EMNLP 2023*, 2023, pp. 12 375–12 396. [Online]. Available: https://aclanthology.org/2023.emnlp-main.761

[152] Y. Li, P. Yuan, S. Feng, B. Pan, X. Wang, B. Sun, H. Wang, and K. Li, "Escape sky-high cost: Early-stopping self-consistency for multi-step reasoning," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2024.

[153] Y. Fu, X. Wang, Y. Tian, and J. Zhao, "Deep think with confidence," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.15260*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.15260

[154] F. Perez and I. Ribeiro, "Ignore previous prompt: Attack techniques for language models," in *NeurIPS ML Safety Workshop*, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2211.09527

[155] Z. Ji, N. Lee, R. Frieske, T. Yu, D. Su, Y. Xu, E. Ishii, Y. J. Bang, A. Madotto, and P. Fung, "Survey of hallucination in natural language generation," *ACM Computing Surveys*, vol. 55, no. 12, pp. 1–38, 2023. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2202.03629